

Granite

Bedrock of a Square: Granite as the Enduring Signature of Union Square

Every previously italicized phrase is highlighted and colour-coded by source. Where the source page is on file, clicking the highlight opens the scan.

COLOUR KEY — ONE COLOUR PER SOURCE · sources with a page scan are marked ↗

■ AIA, *AIA Edition 3*, 1988 p. 186 (1) ↗

■ Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003 pp. 250, 251 (2) ↗

■ LPC, *Union Square*, 1890 p. 1 (1)

■ Richmond, *New York Institutions 1609-1872*, 1872 p. 211 (2) ↗

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1899 p. 1 (1)

■ LPC, *Union Square*, 1903 p. 1 (3) ↗

■ AIA, *Union Square*, 1907 p. 1 (4) ↗

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1904 p. 1 (1)

■ AIA, *Union Square*, 1987 p. 1 (2) ↗

■ Nelson & Sons, *Nelsons Guide to the City of New York*, 1858 p. 39 (1) ↗

■ Cook, *Sacred Havens*, 2001 p. 42 (1) ↗

■ Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016 pp. 346, 470, 515 (3) ↗

■ Postal & Dolkart, *Guide to New York City Landmarks*, 2009 pp. 76, 85 (2) ↗

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1897 p. 1 (2)

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1912 p. 1 (2) ↗

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1959 p. 1 (2) ↗

■ Hennessy, *Walking Broadway*, 2020 p. 97 (1) ↗

■ JG, *Union Square*, 1916 p. 1 (1) ↗

■ Dolkart, *Gramercy*, 1996 pp. 78, 88 (2) ↗

■ Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988 pp. 91, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97 (7) ↗

■ Sharp, *New York City Public Sculpture*, 1974 p. 28 (2) ↗

AUDIO — UNION SQUARE GRANITE | BRICK CAKE 5 min 26 s

Audio track — playable in the HTML version of this document.

Union Square matured into a district where stone spoke a language of permanence, and granite emerged as its unifying signature—surfacing in bulkheads, columns, surrounds, and monumental pedestals alike.

At the northern gateway stands the Lincoln Building at 1 Union Square West, an early skyscraper beheld as *(Romanesque Revival granite crowned with a cornice of 40 little windows with interstitial paired columns)*. Its fabric was *(Sheathed in Indiana limestone, granite, and brick, the building is ornamented with exceptional details)*, and elsewhere it was *(Faced with gray granite, limestone, and brick and decorated with terra cotta)*. A further account records *(The budding, faced in limestone, granite, redbrick, and terra cotta)*, while its footing preserved the plainest testament—*(Granite Bulkheads)*.

Southward, at 5 Union Square, stone persisted in both structure and ornament, its record preserving *(Granite Bulkheads)* and, framing its threshold, *(Granite Ionic Columns)*.

At the southwestern corner rose the Lincoln Monument, at 15 Union Square West, where *(The pedestal consists of three Dix Island granite stones, which weigh in all over forty tons, and is twenty-four feet high)*.

Along the western flank, 17 Union Square West presented *(Granite Bulkheads)* and a *(Granite Surround)*; 21 Union Square West carried the inheritance into its foundation as *(Granite Bulkheads)*; and 29 Union Square West named granite among its base materials—*(Painted Brick, Granite)*—and again at its entrance as a *(Granite Surround)*.

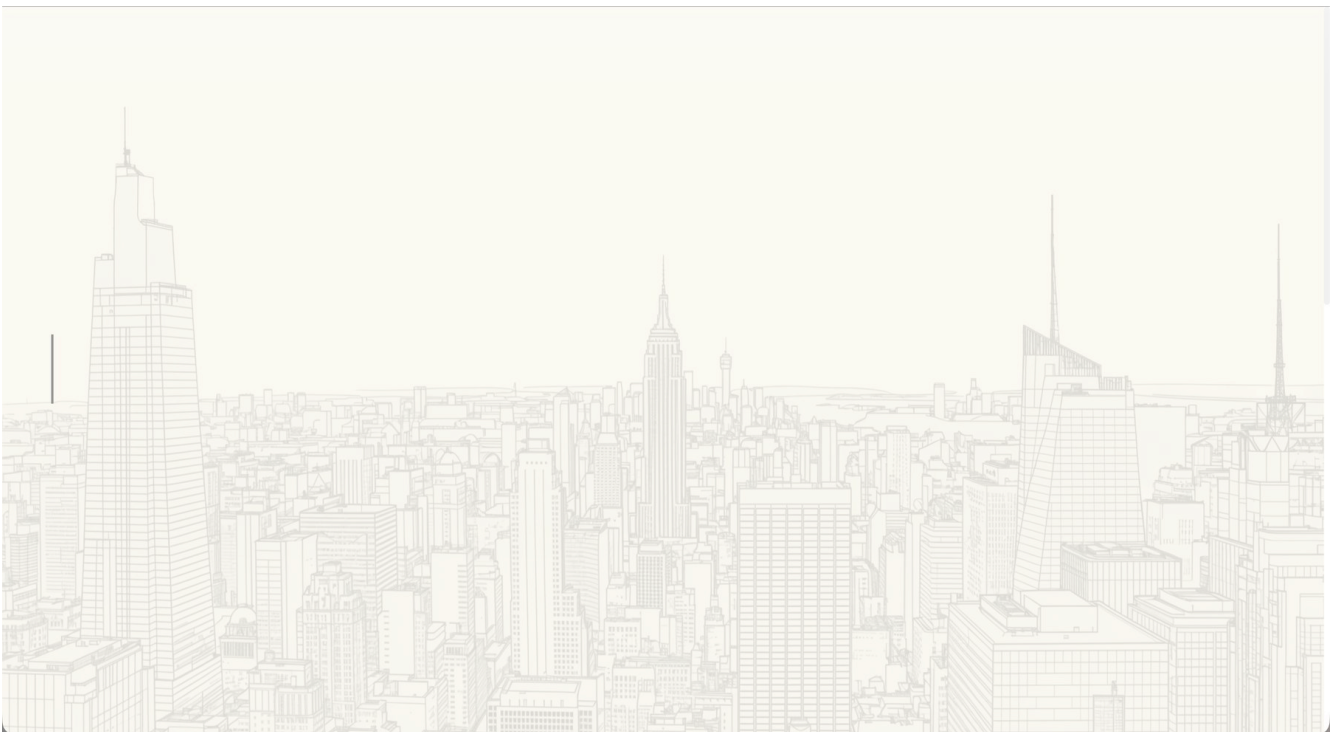
The western row's most eloquent expression belongs to the Bank of the Metropolis at 31 Union Square West, whose record enumerates *(Granite Bulkheads)*, *(Polished Granite Columns)*, and *(Granite Ionic Columns)*. It earned admiration for a design *(enhanced by classical elements traditionally associated with American bank architecture—most notably, a bowed two-story portico with monumental polished-granite columns, lions' heads, consoles, and foliated spandrels)*, and equal praise as *(a welcoming two-story bowed portico supported by a pair of gray granite Ionic columns facing Union Square)*.

The eastern edge answered with the Classical-Revival bank at 20 Union Square East, a temple wrought in stone whose record lists *(Troy Granite)* as base, *(Troy Granite)* as façade, *(Granite Steps)*, and a *(Granite Surround)*. It was hailed as *(The bold academic classicism of this white granite bank building with its Corinthian temple front reveals the design aesthetic of Henry Bacon)*, confirmed where *(The Union Square Bank is a flat-roofed building covered in Troy white granite)*, and distilled in the remark that *(the white granite-front structure boasts a facade of bold Corinthian columns)*.

Granite endured, too, in the eastern neighbors—*(Granite Bulkheads)* at 24 Union Square East and *(Granite Bulkheads)* again at 32 Union Square East. At 44 Union Square East, the Former Tammany Hall *(was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted))*, while at 1 Irving Place a later building named *(Brick, Granite)* among its base materials and set a *(Granite Surround)* at its entrance. Along East 15th Street, the Swannanoa affirmed that *(Its most imposing feature is the two-story base with granite pilasters and projecting portico supported by four granite columns)*.

The square itself endures as an open-air gallery of monuments raised upon granite. The Marquis de Lafayette ascends from a *(granite pedestal)*; the Equestrian Statue of Washington *(is of bronze, and is raised upon a granite pedestal of plain device)*, its form set upon a base of *(14 feet high; granite pedestal)*, recorded as a *(Bronze statue, granite base)*, and remembered where *(The finished statue was mounted on a fourteen-foot granite pedestal designed by the noted New York architect Richard Upjohn (1802 -1878))*. Mohandas Gandhi rests upon a *(granite pedestal)*, further related where *(The life-sized bronze statue rests on a granite base which together measures 14 feet in height)*. The Union Square Drinking Fountain incorporated a *(pink granite pedestal)*, its ornament described where *(The concept of benign nature underlies the decorative motifs of birds, fruit, flowers, and four lizards embellishing the octagonal pink granite pedestal)*. Abraham Lincoln

stands upon a *(granite pedestal)* of *(three Dix Island granite stones, which weigh in all over forty tons)*, and at the heart of the square rises the Charles F. Murphy Memorial Flagpole, anchored by a *(Granite flagpole base, 36 feet in diameter)*.



CITATION CHART

Every highlighted quote, in order of appearance, correlated to its underlying source. The swatch matches the highlight colour in the text.

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
1	"Romanesque Revival granite crowned with a cornice of 40 little windows with interstitial paired columns"	AIA, <i>AIA Edition 3</i> , 1988, p. 186 [page scan]
2	"Sheathed in Indiana limestone, granite, and brick, the building is ornamented with exceptional details"	Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 346 [page scan]
3	"Faced with gray granite, limestone, and brick and decorated with terra cotta"	Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 251 [page scan]
4	"The budding, faced in limestone, granite, redbrick, and terra cotta"	Postal & Dolkart, <i>Guide to New York City Landmarks</i> , 2009, p. 76 [page scan]
5	"Granite Bulkheads"	LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1890, p. 1
6	"Granite Bulkheads"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1897, p. 1
7	"Granite Ionic Columns"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1897, p. 1
8	"The pedestal consists of three Dix Island granite stones, which weigh in all over forty tons, and is twenty-four feet high"	Richmond, <i>New York Institutions 1609-1872</i> , 1872, p. 211 [page scan]
9	"Granite Bulkheads"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1912, p. 1 [page scan]
10	"Granite Surround"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1912, p. 1 [page scan]
11	"Granite Bulkheads"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1989, p. 1
12	"Painted Brick, Granite"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1959, p. 1 [page scan]
13	"Granite Surround"	JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1959, p. 1 [page scan]
14	"Granite Bulkheads"	LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1903, p. 1 [page scan]
15	"Polished Granite Columns"	LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1903, p. 1 [page scan]
16	"Granite Ionic Columns"	LPC, <i>Union Square</i> , 1903, p. 1 [page scan]
17	"enhanced by classical elements traditionally associated with American bank architecture—most notably, a bowed two-story portico with monumental polished-granite columns,..."	Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 470 [page scan]
18	"a welcoming two-story bowed portico supported by a pair of gray granite Ionic columns facing Union Square"	Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 97 [page scan]
19	"Troy Granite"	AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1907, p. 1 [page scan]
20	"Troy Granite"	AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1907, p. 1 [page scan]
21	"Granite Steps"	AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1907, p. 1 [page scan]

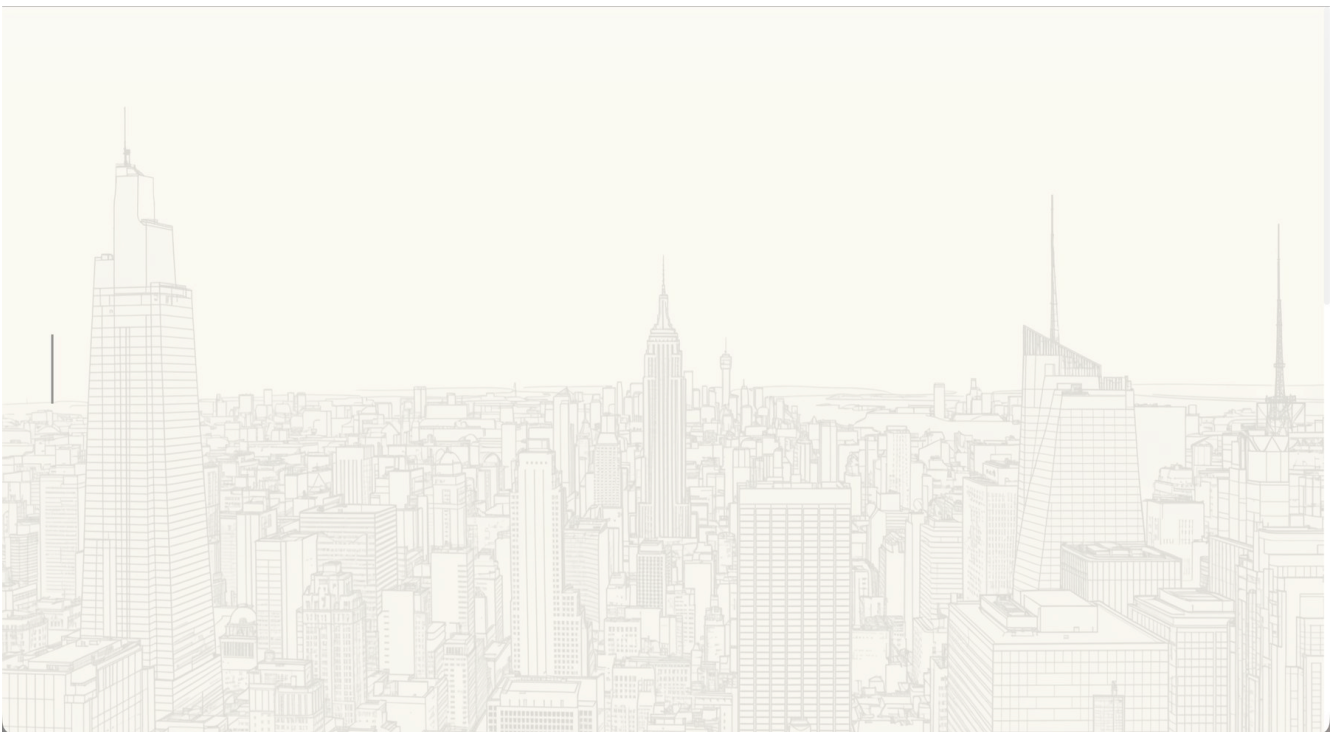
#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
22	"Granite Surround"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1907, p. 1 [page scan]
23	"The bold academic classicism of this white granite bank building with its Corinthian temple front reveals the design aesthetic of Henry Bacon"	 Postal & Dolkart, <i>Guide to New York City Landmarks</i> , 2009, p. 85 [page scan]
24	"The Union Square Bank is a flat-roofed building covered in Troy white granite"	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 515 [page scan]
25	"the white granite-front structure boasts a facade of bold Corinthian columns"	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
26	"Granite Bulkheads"	 JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1916, p. 1 [page scan]
27	"Granite Bulkheads"	 JG, <i>Union Square</i> , 1904, p. 1
28	"was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted)"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 78 [page scan]
29	"Brick, Granite"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1987, p. 1 [page scan]
30	"Granite Surround"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1987, p. 1 [page scan]
31	"Its most imposing feature is the two-story base with granite pilasters and projecting portico supported by four granite columns"	 Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i> , 1996, p. 88 [page scan]
32	"granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 97 [page scan]
33	"is of bronze, and is raised upon a granite pedestal of plain device"	 Nelson & Sons, <i>Nelsons Guide to the City of New York</i> , 1858, p. 39 [page scan]
34	"14 feet high; granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 91 [page scan]
35	"Bronze statue, granite base"	 Sharp, <i>New York City Public Sculpture</i> , 1974, p. 28 [page scan]
36	"The finished statue was mounted on a fourteen-foot granite pedestal designed by the noted New York architect Richard Upjohn (1802 -1878)"	 Sharp, <i>New York City Public Sculpture</i> , 1974, p. 28 [page scan]
37	"granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 93 [page scan]
38	"The life-sized bronze statue rests on a granite base which together measures 14 feet in height"	 Cook, <i>Sacred Havens</i> , 2001, p. 42 [page scan]
39	"pink granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 94 [page scan]
40	"The concept of benign nature underlies the decorative motifs of birds, fruit, flowers, and four lizards embellishing the octagonal pink granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 94 [page scan]
41	"granite pedestal"	 Gayle & Cohen, <i>Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures</i> , 1988, p. 96 [page scan]
42	"three Dix Island granite stones, which weigh in all over forty tons"	 Richmond, <i>New York Institutions 1609-1872</i> , 1872, p. 211 [page scan]

Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)

Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)

43 "Granite flagpole base, 36 feet in diameter"

■ Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 95 [page scan]



SOURCE PAGES

27 scanned pages, one per cited source page. Each lists the highlighted quotes drawn from it.



AIA, *AIA Edition 3*, 1988, p. 186

Quotes drawn from this page: 1





[W 3.] **American Savings Bank/originally Union Square Savings Bank**, 20 Union Sq. E., NE cor. E. 15th St. 1924. Henry Bacon.

A classy **Corinthian colonnade** is somewhat forlorn in these precincts. **Bacon's** best remembrance is the **Lincoln Memorial**.



[W 4a.] **Guardian Life Insurance Company/originally Germania Life Insurance Company**, 201 Park Ave. S., NE cor. E. 17th St. 1911. D'Oench & Yost. [W 4b.] **Annex**, 105 E. 17th St., bet. Park Ave. S. and Irving Place. 1961. Skidmore, Owings & Merrill.

The **mansarded** bulk of this **Renaissance Revival** marvel is best seen from a distance, down 17th Street or from the adjacent Union Square Park. **Germania Life** was a name that became an onerous millstone at the advent of World War I. The board of directors agreed to rename it, picking a name with the largest number of reusable letters that they could find. **Guardian** still crowns the roof against its mansard backdrop.

Next door is the sleek annex, a simple grid of **aluminum and glass** infilled behind with white vertical blinds. As an accessory, it is a graceful annex to the proud parent, unabashedly "modern," an articulated annex.



[W 2.] Zeckendorf Towers (apts.)



[W 5.] Century Building at Union Sq.



[W 5.] Originally **The Century Building**, 33 E. 17th St., bet. Park Ave. S. and Broadway to W. 18th St. 1881. William Schickel. ★

This red brick and whitestone charmer is where the popular Cen-

tury magazine (for grown-ups) and **St. Nicholas** (for boys and girls) were published before the century turned.

[W 6.] 31 Union Square West/originally Bank of the Metropolis Building, NW cor. 16th St. 1903. Bruce Price.

An early and unwitting **sliver building**, this neo-Renaissance slab now houses a restaurant in its original banking rooms, a place for **SUPERMAN'S** lunch.

[W 7.] Originally Lincoln Building, 1 Union Sq. W., NW cor. E. 14th St. 1890. R. H. Robertson

Romanesque Revival granite crowned with a cornice of 40 little windows with interstitial paired columns.

[W 8.] Originally YWCA (Young Women's Christian Association)/formerly Rand School, 7 E. 15th St., bet. Union Sq. W. and Fifth Ave. ca. 1889. R. H. Robertson.

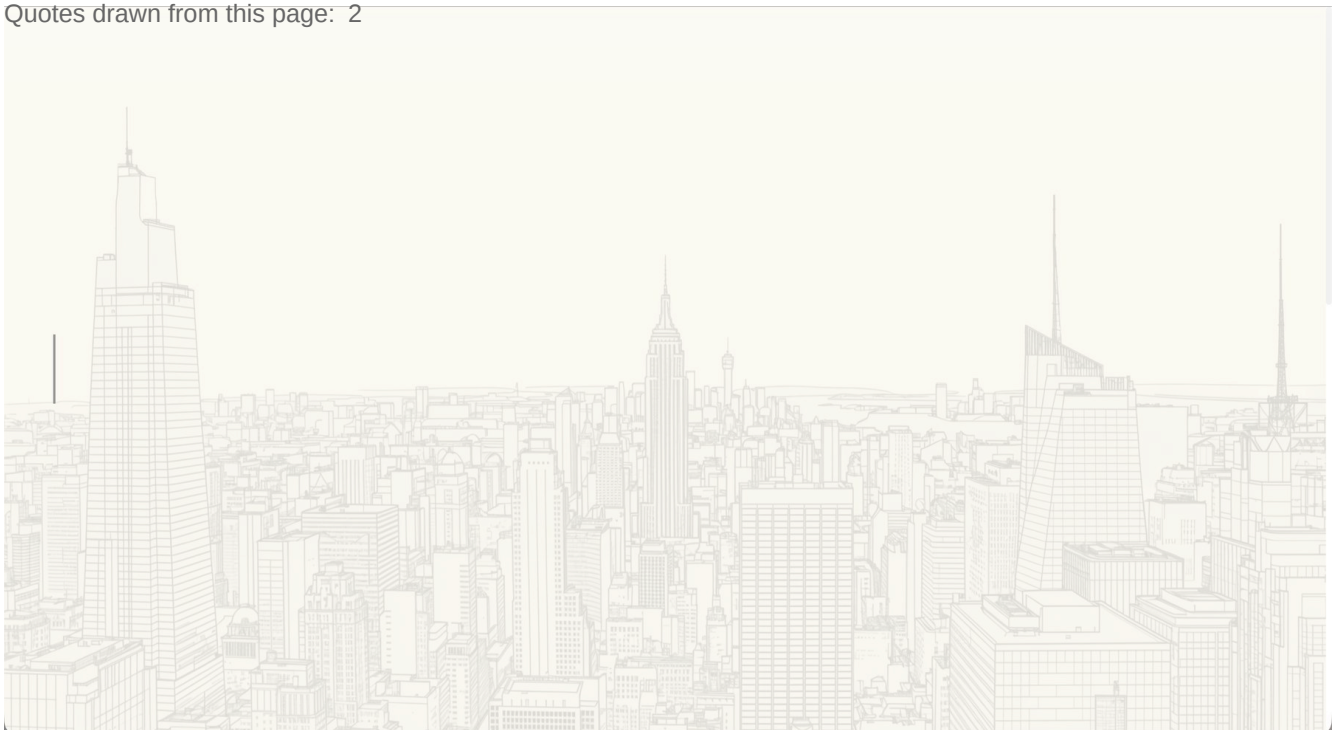
Romanesque Revival in granite, brick, and brownstone. The grand bay windows give the entrance portal a stronger stature.



[W 9a.] Sidney Hillman Health Center/originally Margaret Louisa Home, YWCA (lodging house), 16 E. 16th St., bet. Union Sq. W. and Fifth Ave. 1890. R. H. Robertson.

Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016, p. 346

Quotes drawn from this page: 2





CHARLES A. VISSANI HOUSE

priests who lived there; it even contained a chapel. Vissani had been appointed the first Commissary General of the Holy Land for the United States in 1880. The main tasks of the Commissariat—which moved to Washington, D.C., in 1889 and is still in operation today—are to increase public awareness about the holy places of Jerusalem and to preserve and recover the sanctuaries of Palestine.

Since 1946, the property has been used as a multiunit residence, with additional units created in 1969. Nevertheless, the building's ecclesiastical overtones, heightened by pointed and ogee arches, pinnacles, trefoils, drip moldings, and lush foliated tympana, serve as an imposing reminder of its original mission.



LINCOLN BUILDING

LINCOLN BUILDING

1889–90; 2015–

1–3 UNION SQUARE WEST, MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: R.H. ROBERTSON;
RESTORATION, WALTER B. MELVIN
ARCHITECTS

DESIGNATED: JULY 12, 1988

When the Commissioners Map of 1807–11 first laid out Manhattan's grid plan, the acute angle where Bloomingdale Road (now Broadway) intersected the Bowery at 16th Street demarcated an island of land that was dubbed Union Place. Initially, the poor built shanties there, but by 1839, Union Square (as it came to be known) had been graded, paved, and fenced in, and it was set aside for military and civic parades and festivities. By the 1850s,

mansions had sprung up around the picturesque square. Within a few decades, tall commercial buildings, like the nine-story Lincoln, replaced the mansions as the city grew northward.

Combining metal-skeleton interior construction with masonry-bearing walls, the Lincoln represents a transitional phase in skyscraper construction. The essential criterion of a true skyscraper is the replacement of load-bearing walls with a steel skeleton that provides all of the structural support. In the Lincoln Building, Romanesque Revival arcades articulate the skeletal construction, although the massiveness of the walls is evident, and the horizontality of traditional masonry is further emphasized by the stacked fenestration. Sheathed in Indiana limestone, granite, and brick, the building is ornamented with exceptional details: acanthus scrolls, Byzantine capitals, griffins, and human and lion heads, all carved in terra cotta. In late 2015, plans were approved by the NYC Department of Buildings for façade repairs and roof replacement.

NORWOOD NEWS, FORMERLY WILLIAMSBRIDGE RESERVOIR KEEPER'S HOUSE

1889–90; 1998

3400 RESERVOIR OVAL (ALSO KNOWN AS 3450 PUTNAM PLACE), THE BRONX

ARCHITECT: GEORGE W. BIRDSALL, CHIEF ENGINEER, CROTON AQUEDUCT, FOR NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS

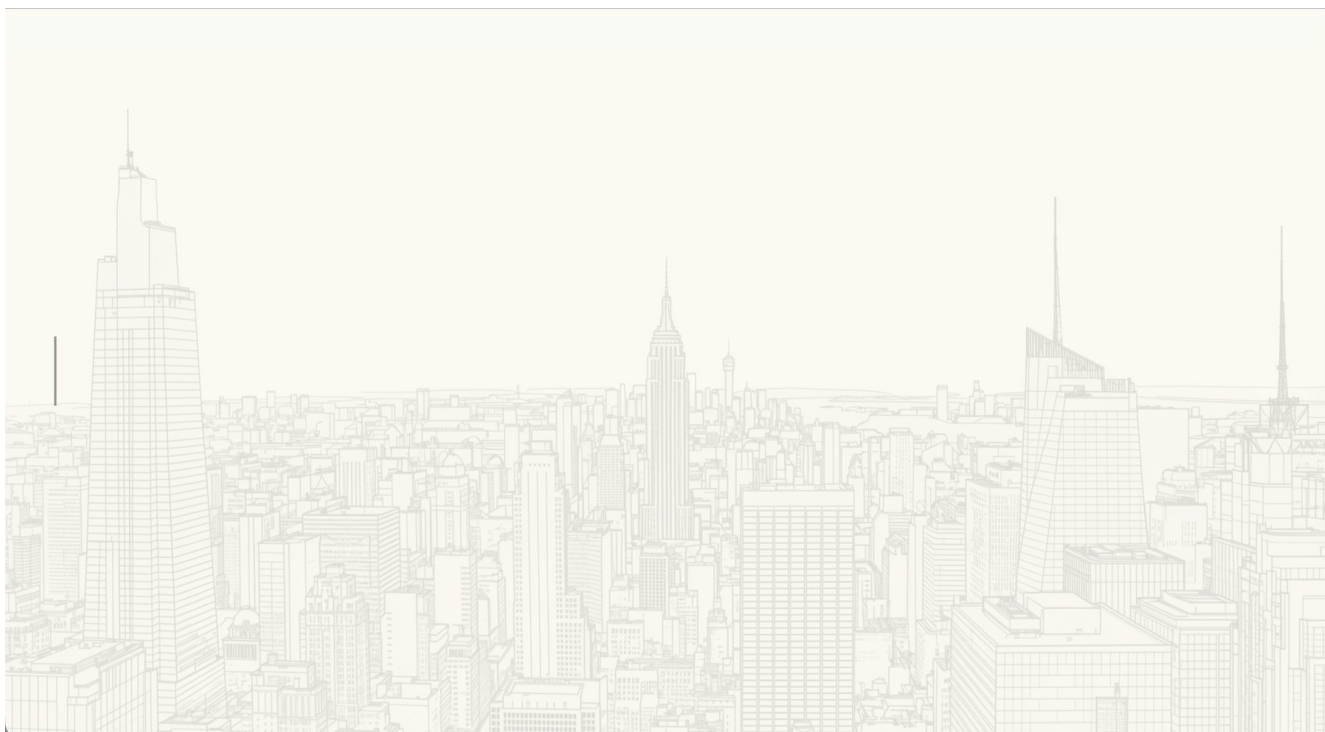
DESIGNATED: FEBRUARY 8, 2000

The Reservoir Keeper's House is the only remaining building in New York City from the Bronx and Byram Rivers



Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 251

Quotes drawn from this page: 3



of Liberty, Bartholdi offered the Lafayette statue as a token of French friendship with the American people in gratitude for their sympathy during the Franco-Prussian War. Lafayette, although an aristocrat, was sympathetic with the cause of the American Revolution and served as a Major General in the Continental Army. The pedestal is designed to resemble a ship's prow. 870.1

Facing Union Square between 14th and 15th streets is massive **Zeckendorf Towers** (Davis Brody & Assocs., William Zeckendorf, Jr., developer, 1987), a 670-unit condominium in four 29-story towers, topped by open framework pyramids. The towers are set on a seven-story base that fills a triangular plot while maintaining the orientation to the city street grid. Original plans called for much taller structures, but fierce community opposition forced the developer to scale them down, thus reducing the "darkening and overwhelming" effect on the park below and respecting Union Square's surroundings. The lower floors include retail establishments and also Beth Israel Medical Center facilities. At the very corner of the building at 14th Street was **Joe's Saloon**, rendered immortal by habitué Hugh A. D'Arcy, who, in 1887, penned the sentimental ballad *The Face on the Barroom Floor*.

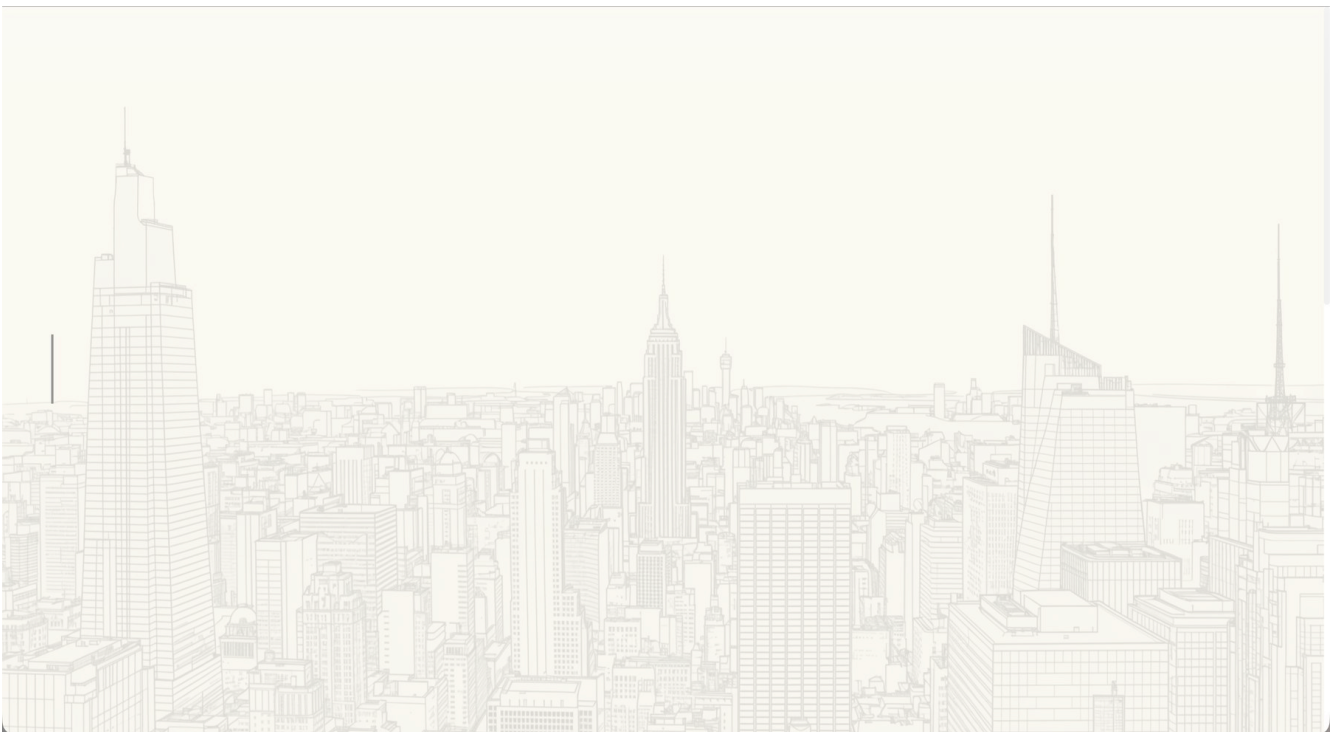
Turn right (west) on Union Square South, but stay on the park side. The building complex on the block between Fourth Avenue and Broadway comprises Circuit City, a Virgin Megastore, and a United Artists theater, plus residential apartments (Davis Brody Bond and Schuman Lichtenstein Claman & Efron, 1999). The 15 changing illuminated five-foot-high numerals display "the hours, minutes, seconds elapsed in the day; and the hours, minutes, and seconds remaining, symbolizing the city's speed, frenzy, and fragmentation." Intrinsic in the display is the astonishing multimedia sculpture of brick, concrete, steel, aluminum, gold leaf, incandescent light, steam, and sound called **Metronome** (Kristin Jones/Andrew Ginzel, 1999). A gift to New York, it is intended as a "celebration of the energy and vitality of the city." From the five-foot circle *Infinity*, steam emanates at noon and midnight, while from the 67-foot-long cone, a low tone is produced to synchronize with the plume of steam. Among other features are a five-foot rotating sphere of gold and black that mirrors the phases of the moon and *Relic*, an enlarged replica of the right hand of George Washington from the equestrian statue in the Park. Occupying the mid-block from 1870 to 1936 was the (old) **Union Square Theatre**, which survived as a converted retail store until it was demolished in 1990. 845.1

Dominating the Park entrance is the historic bronze **equestrian statue of George Washington** (Henry Kirke Brown with John Quincy Adams Ward, 1856; granite pedestal by Richard Upjohn). The statue represents Washington entering New York City on Evacuation Day, November 25, 1783, marking the end of British occupation during the Revolutionary War. The sculpture is based on an earlier Houdon bust and is considered one of the finest equestrian statues in America. It was moved from its original location at the intersection of Fourth Avenue early in the 20th century. [See engraving, page 227.]

Turn right at the Gandhi statue (described earlier) and walk north on Union Square West; note the recent attempt to re-create an “old-time” atmosphere by paving the street with Belgian blocks. At the corner of 14th Street, the **former Lincoln Building**, No. 1 Union Square West (R. H. Robertson, 1899), is a typical

Postal & Dolkart, *Guide to New York City Landmarks*, 2009, p. 76

Quotes drawn from this page: 4



MANHATTAN

was designed to attract the attention of riders on the Sixth Avenue Elevated, which ran in front of the building.

195 **5, 7, 9, 17, 19, 21, and 23 West 16th Street** (c. 1845–46), designated individually 1990. In the 1840s the streets adjacent to Fifth Avenue just north of 14th Street were developed with row houses. Most of these structures were demolished as commerce invaded the area in the late 19th century, but West 16th Street retains a significant number of Greek Revival houses. The most impressive are the four survivors of a row of nine wide houses—Nos. 5, 7, 9, and 17—each of which has a full-height curving bay on its front facade, an extremely rare feature in New York. In 1930 the family-planning pioneer Margaret Sanger moved her Birth Control Clinical Research Bureau into No. 17. Nos. 19 and 21 are simpler houses displaying fine ironwork, while No. 23 has a magnificent cast-iron balcony and stoop railing. All the houses have wide stone entrance enframements with battered sides and eared corners; this is a classic Greek form copied from the window surrounds on Greek temples.

197 **Lincoln Building, 1–3 Union Square West** (R. H. Robertson, 1889–90), designated 1988. The Lincoln Building is representative of the early skyscraper form as it evolved in New York, where architects chose to adapt already-popular styles to this new building type. Robertson designed the Lincoln Building in the same Romanesque Revival style that he used for churches, houses, and other structures. The building, faced in limestone, granite, red brick, and terra cotta, marks an important transitional phase in skyscraper engineering: it was constructed with a metal framing in combination with traditional masonry bearing walls.

198 **Bank of the Metropolis, 31 Union Square West** (Bruce Price, 1902–03), designated 1988. Price was an important early skyscraper designer with a particular interest in adapting the tripartite form of the column to tall buildings. This neo-Renaissance limestone-faced example is clearly massed in Price's preferred base-shaft-capital manner. The Bank of the Metropolis, founded in 1871 to serve the needs of businesses in the Union Square area, maintained its offices on the square until 1918, when it was absorbed by the Bank of Manhattan.

199 **Decker Building, now the Union Building, 33 Union Square West** (John Edelman in the employ of Alfred Zucker, 1892–93), designated 1988. A rare example of a Moorish-inspired skyscraper, the headquarters of the

Decker Piano Company was designed by John Edelman, mentor and friend of Louis Sullivan. Many features of the Decker Building, most notably the naturalistic ornament, reflect Sullivan's influence. Between 1968 and 1974 Andy Warhol's Factory occupied the sixth floor. The base was handsomely restored in 1995.

200 **Century Building, now Barnes & Noble Bookstore, 33 East 17th Street** (William Schickel, 1880–81), designated 1986. The red brick Century Building is a rare New York example of a Queen Anne-style commercial structure. Erected to house the prestigious Century Publishing Company, publisher of *The Century* and *St. Nicholas* magazines, the building is characteristic of the finest Queen Anne design in its free use of classical motifs in stone and terra cotta and its employment of the style's trademark sunflowers. After standing vacant for many years, the building was converted into a bookstore, and the facade received an award-winning restoration.

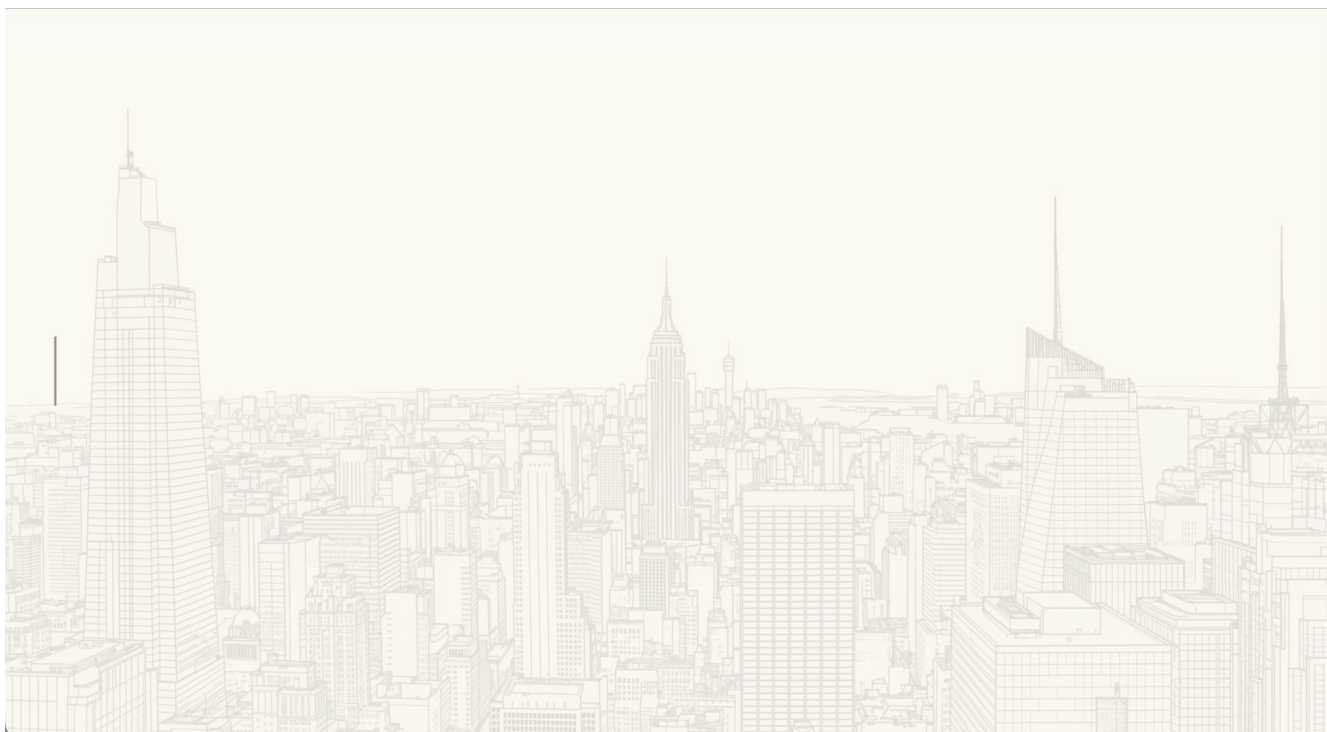
201 **Everett Building, 200 Park Avenue South** (Goldwin Starrett & Van Vleck, 1908), designated 1988. Located on the north side of Union Square, the Everett Building exemplifies an important development in the design of commercial high-rise buildings—the construction of functional, fireproof structures with large windows, open floor space, and simple classical detail. This emphasis on functionalism reflects the influence of Chicago skyscraper designs; in fact, the architect, Goldwin Starrett, had worked for four years in the Chicago office of Daniel Burnham.

202 **Gorham Manufacturing Company Building, 809–891 Broadway** (Edward Hale Kendall, 1883–84; alteration, John H. Duncan, 1912), designated 1984. This commercial building in the Queen Anne style was erected for the Gorham Manufacturing Company, a leading American silver firm, for its retail outlet in the exclusive Ladies' Mile shopping district. The Gorham is an early example of a mixed-use building: only the lower two floors were occupied by the store; the upper floors were rented as bachelor apartments. By 1893, however, the building was entirely in commercial use. The architect John H. Duncan is responsible for a remodeling of the building in 1912 that entailed the removal of a corner tower and the addition of roof dormers. The building now contains shops at street level and apartments above.

203 **Lord & Taylor Store, 901 Broadway** (James H. Giles, 1869–70), designated 1977. Two English immigrants, Samuel Lord and George Taylor, founded the dry goods firm

Richmond, *New York Institutions 1609-1872, 1872*, p. 211

Quotes drawn from this page: 8 42



for his wealth and avarice. The subject being presented, the miser stated that he could give nothing, and remarked that no monument was necessary. Laying his hand upon his breast he exclaimed, with emphasis, "*I keep the Father of his country here.*" "Well," responded the intrepid collector, "if the Father of his country is *there*, he is in the *tightest place* he ever found."

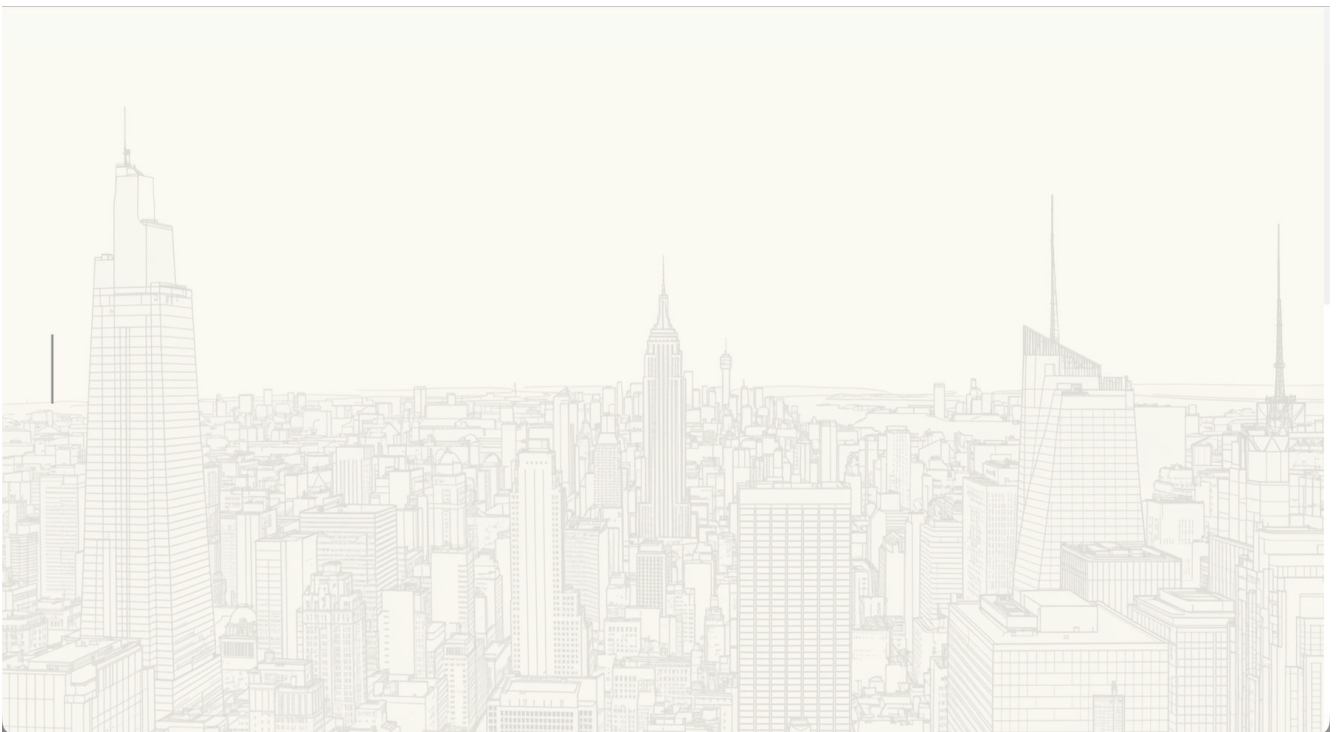
THE LINCOLN MONUMENT, erected in September, 1870, by the Union League Club, stands at the south-west corner of Union square, and corresponds in position with the Washington monument on the opposite corner. The pedestal consists of three Dix Island granite stones, which weigh in all over forty tons, and is twenty-four feet high. The statue, which represents the deceased statesman in citizen's dress, but covered with a Roman toga, is of bronze, nearly eleven feet high, and weighs three thousand pounds. The design was formed by H. K. Brown, Esq., and is a faithful representation of the martyred President. In his left hand he holds the Proclamation of Emancipation, and a galaxy of stars on the pedestal represent the States of the Union.

THE VANDERBILT MONUMENT, erected in 1869, and crowning the western wall of the immense freight depot which covers the old St. John's Park, is by far the most elaborate and costly undertaking of its kind on Manhattan. It was conceived, and carried forward to completion, mainly through the untiring exertions of Captain Albert De Groot. The whole scene in bronze is one hundred and fifty feet long, and over thirty feet high, with admirable groupings of ancient and modern representations, and is designed to allegorically exhibit the brilliant and successful career of the dashing Commodore. The central and chief figure is the Railroad King, a life-like and correct statue, twelve feet high, weighing over four tons. On the left of this central figure everything is seafaring, representing his early beginnings on the

New York Bay, his later travels, and his patriotic munificence.
In the distance Neptune in bold relief is seen, in a half-re-

JG, *Union Square*, 1912, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 9 10

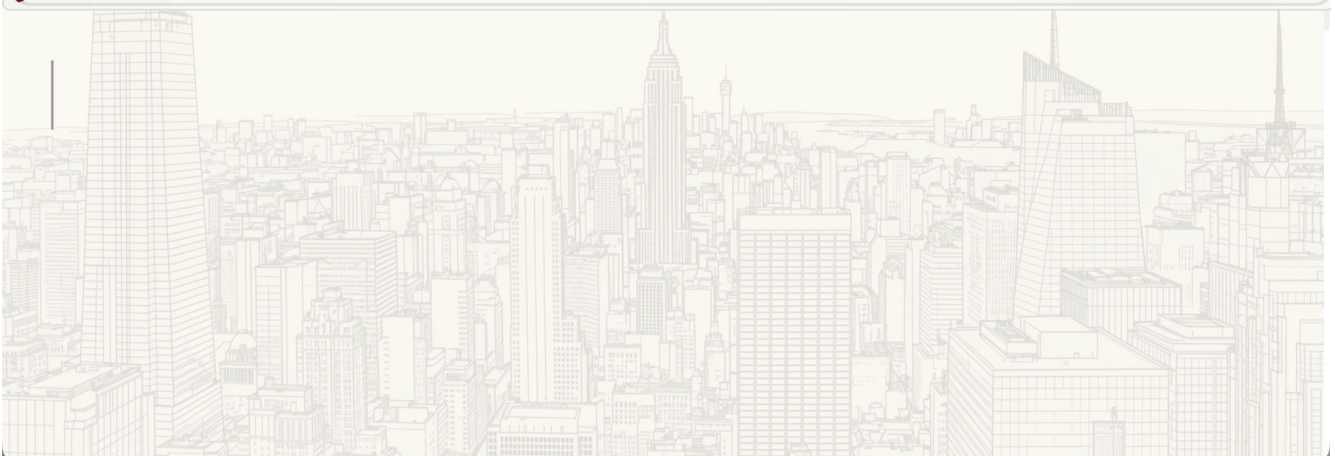


“<Architecture Style>_Beaux-Arts, <Base Color>_Timberwolf - 217 214 208, <Façade Color>_Crystal - 213 213 213, <Base Material>_Rusticated Limestone, Granite Bulkheads, <Façade Material>_Limestone, <Entrance Description>_Storefront, 3 Bays, Granite Surround, Transom, <Window Detail>_Stone Surround, Flat Arch Lintel (2), Arched (U), Window Panes: [1/1], <Brickwork Style>_Rusticated Base, Palmettes, Trefoil, Cartouches, Swags, Brackets, Tripartite Typology, <Roofline Description>_Projecting Cornice, Brackets, Cartouches.”

JG · (1912) UNION SQUARE · 1912 · P. 1

Mentioned as: "17 Union Square West"

[View Document Image](#)

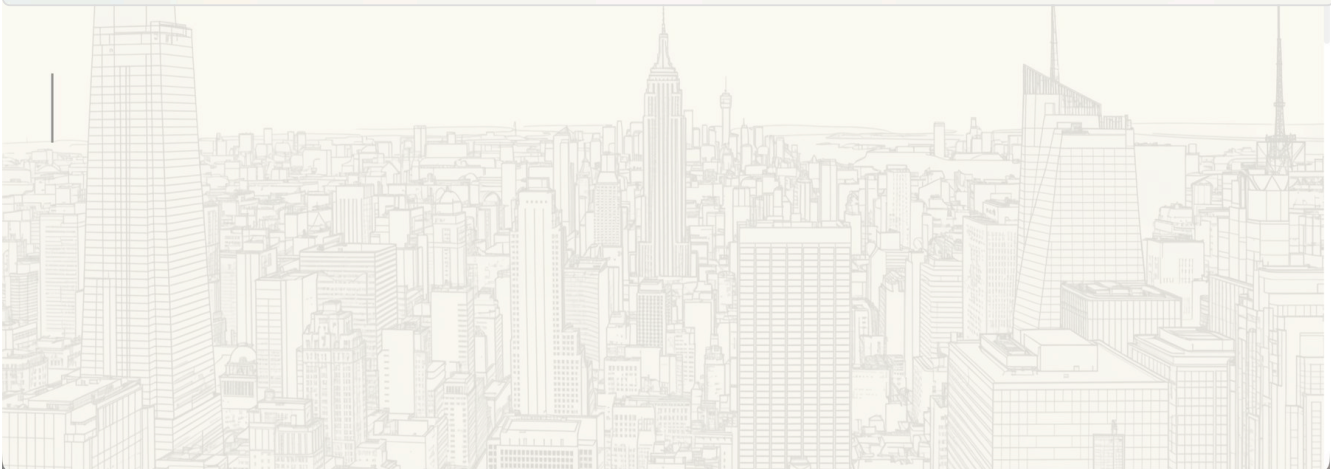


“<Architecture Style>_Postmodern, <Base Color>_Slate - 64 78 69, <Façade Color>_Aqua Marine - 72 138 116, White Shimmer - 217 224 227, <Base Material>_Painted Brick, Granite, <Façade Material>_Glass, Aluminum, Composite Panels, <Entrance Description>_Storefront, Granite Surround, Transom, <Window Detail>_Aluminum Frame, Window Panes: [1/1], <Brickwork Style>_Running Bond, Stack Bond, <Roofline Description>_Parapet, Flat.”

JG · (1959) UNION SQUARE · 1959 · P. 1

Mentioned as: “29 Union Square West”

[View Document Image](#)



LPC, *Union Square*, 1903, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 14 15 16



"<Architecture Style>_neo-Renaissance, <Base Color>_Coral Reef - 195 185 154, <Façade Color>_Pearl White - 238 235 218, <Base Material>_Rusticated Limestone, Granite Bulkheads, Polished Granite Columns, <Façade Material>_Limestone, <Entrance Description>_3-Bays, 2-Story Bowed Portico, Granite Ionic Columns, Lions' Heads, Console Brackets, Foliated Spandrels, Broken Pediment, Lion-head Waterspouts, Frieze, <Window Detail>_Square-headed, Stone Surround (3), Foliated Spandrels: Acanthus/ Roundel Centers (Rest), Open-mouthed Lions (10), <Brickwork Style>_Rusticated Pilasters, Round Headed Arches, Smooth Faced Pilasters, Swags, Egg & Dart Echinus, Tripartite Typology, <Roofline Description>_Scrolled Consoles, Wave/ 'Running Dog', Projecting Bandcourse, Palmettes, Copper Cornice, Dentils, Modillions."

LPC · (1903) UNION SQUARE · 1903 · P. 1

Mentioned as: "31 Union Square West"

[View Document Image](#)

Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016, p. 470

Quotes drawn from this page: 17





UNITY CENTER OF PRACTICAL CHRISTIANITY

widely known for her generosity and unflagging support of worthy causes. When she died in 1938, *The New York Times* called her "the best-loved woman in the country." At the time the stable was constructed, the stretch of 58th Street between Fifth Avenue and Broadway resembled a mews. Area residents stabled their horses here, while those who enjoyed driving through nearby Central Park appreciated the convenience of the commercial liveries in the area. Gould, who lived in the Fifth Avenue mansion bequeathed to her by her father, demolished an existing stable to make way for this carriage house.

Architect Phillip Sawyer had studied for a year at the École des Beaux-Arts in Paris, and elements of this Parisian-style façade suggest the uniform,

symmetrical elevations of the Place des Vosges. A suave, dignified effect is achieved by the building's subtle verticality, the attenuated hipped slate roof and tall flanking chimneys, and the limestone tethering rings at the arched entrance. Ornamentation, like the flat voussoirs of the third-story windows and the triglyph brackets supporting the cornice, imbue this chiefly utilitarian building with an unmistakable air of luxury.

In 1921, the building was converted to a garage, with space for four automobiles and an apartment for the chauffeur on the second and third floors. The interior was renovated as a shoe show room and two apartments in 1957; since 1982, it has housed a church, the Unity Center of Practical Christianity. A façade restoration was completed in 2007.

(FORMER) BANK OF THE METROPOLIS

1902–03; 1979 CONVERSION

31 UNION SQUARE WEST (ALSO KNOWN AS 19–23 EAST 16TH STREET), MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: BRUCE PRICE

DESIGNATED: JULY 12, 1988

Founded in 1871, the Bank of the Metropolis was formed to serve the needs of the businesses located around Union Square. In order to attract the business of leading publishers, jewelers, and other merchants, the board of directors included such powerful neighborhood businessmen as Louis Comfort Tiffany and Charles Scribner. The bank was absorbed by the Bank of



(FORMER) BANK OF THE METROPOLIS

the Manhattan Company in 1918; the resulting entity merged with Chase in 1955 to become the Chase Manhattan Bank, now JP Morgan Chase & Co.

Occupying a commanding corner location, the building superbly demonstrates Bruce Price's ability to use the requirements of function, the dictates of site, and a classical vocabulary to create a skyscraper that emanates authority. The neo-Renaissance limestone tower is enhanced by classical elements traditionally associated with American bank architecture—most notably, a bowed two-story portico with monumental polished-granite columns, lions' heads, consoles, and foliated spandrels.

The site demanded a long, thin



Hennessy, *Walking Broadway*, 2020, p. 97

Quotes drawn from this page: 18



Plant forms are abstracted and stylized under the influence of Moorish decoration to create this lush patterning. The central tower is an Islamic extravaganza and was once topped by a minaret.

From 1967 to 1973 the sixth floor of the Decker Building housed Andy Warhol's celebrated Factory. It was here in 1968 that the artist was shot by Valerie Solanas. Warhol subsequently relocated the Factory diagonally across the street to 860 Broadway.



97

E Bank of the Metropolis

31 Union Square West

844

1903 · BRUCE PRICE

The familiar, sober classical vocabulary of bank architecture is enlivened here by a welcoming two-story bowed portico supported by a pair of gray granite Ionic columns facing Union Square. The long 16th Street elevation also features some distinctive touches. Notice the flattened arches floating in the openings of the ground level arcade and the lush foliate ornament in the panels under the windows higher up. A powerfully detailed balcony at the thirteenth story prepares the way for a bold copper cornice.

The block between 14th and 15th Streets offers two solid and accomplished historic structures: the **Spingler Building** (5 Union Square West, 1897, W. H. Hume and Sons) and the **Lincoln Building** (1 Union Square West, 1889, R. H. Robertson). The two facades share many compositional details, but one architect has chosen a classical vocabulary while the other has embraced the Romanesque.

842

More unusual is the contemporary building at 15 Union Square West. Behind the steel and glass are the arches of the cast iron facade from John Kellum's 1869 headquarters for **Tiffany & Company**. The top seven floors were added to the original five when the building was converted to condominiums in 2009.

842

“<Architecture Style>_Classical-Revival, Greek-Revival,
<Base Color>_Crystal - 213 213 213, <Façade
Color>_Crystal - 213 213 213, <Base Material>_Troy
Granite , Concrete, <Façade Material>_Troy Granite ,
<Entrance Description>_Freestanding Portico,
Corinthian Columns, Monumental Entrance, Granite
Steps, Coffered Ceiling, Frieze, Granite Surround, Egg &
Dart, <Window Detail>_5 Bays, Corinthian Pilasters,
Bronze Frames, Stone Surround, Incised Lintel,
Bracketed/ Projecting Greek Key Sill, <Brickwork
Style>_Rusticated Corners, Wreaths, Swags, Medallions,
<Roofline Description>_Projecting Cornice, Dentils, Egg
& Dart, Balustrade, Carved Lion Faces.”

AIA · (1907) UNION SQUARE · 1907 · P. 1

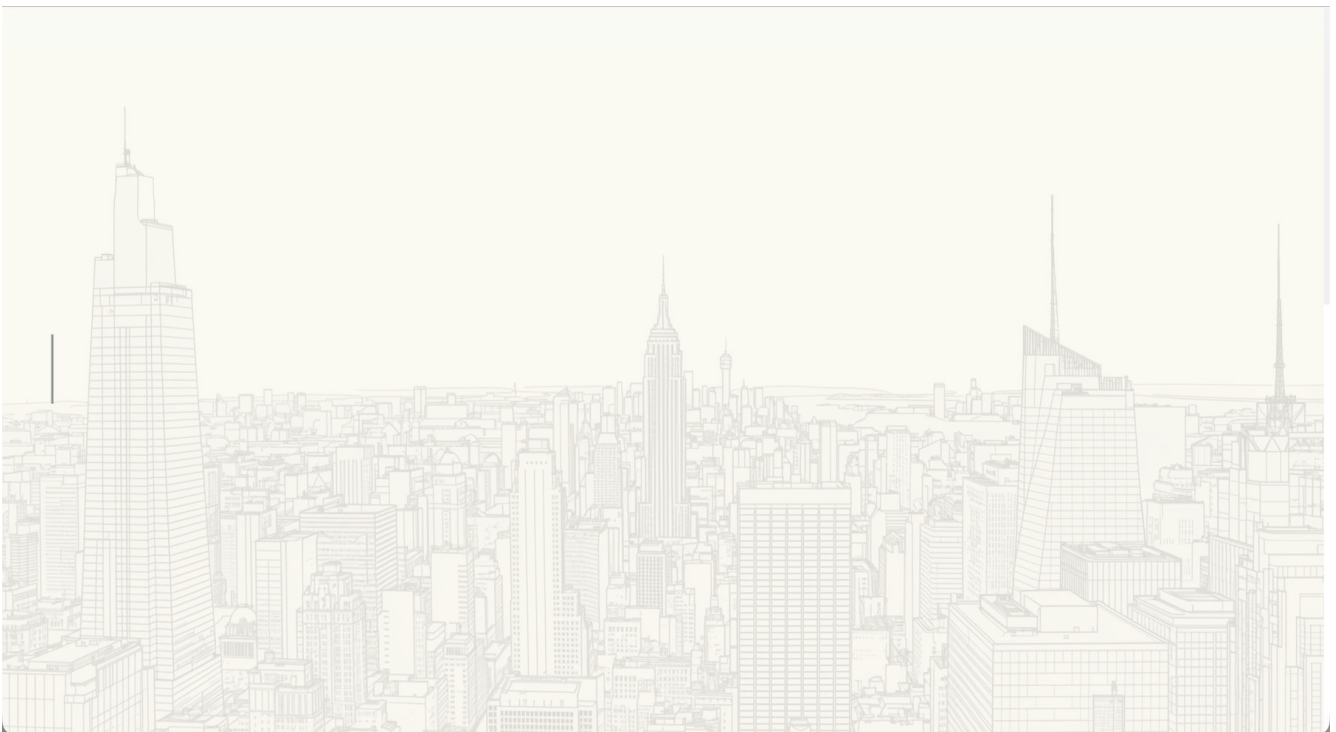
Mentioned as: “20 Union Square East”

[View Document Image](#)



Postal & Dolkart, *Guide to New York City Landmarks*, 2009, p. 85

Quotes drawn from this page: 23



artistic details. This is especially evident on East 19th Street, between Irving Place and Third Avenue, known as the "Block Beautiful," where beginning in 1909, the architect Frederick H. Sterner renovated many houses.

❖ **Stuyvesant Square Historic District**, designated 1975. Stuyvesant Square was laid out in 1846 on land donated to the city by Peter Gerard Stuyvesant. The square is divided by Second Avenue, and each of its two parts is surrounded by an original cast-iron fence. Stuyvesant Square provides a fine setting for two of New York's most distinguished landmarks, the Friends Meeting House and Seminary (see No. 231) and Saint George's Church (Episcopal) (see No. 232). The earliest Greek Revival houses in the district were erected in 1842–43 at 214–216 East 18th Street, when residential development reached north of 14th Street. Most of the district's houses, however, were built in the 1850s, when late Greek Revival, Italianate, and Anglo-Italianate rows were constructed. One of the latest single-family dwellings in the district is the Sidney Webster House (1883) at 245 East 17th Street, the only surviving residence in New York City designed by the architect Richard Morris Hunt.

INDIVIDUAL LANDMARKS

❖ **Union Square Savings Bank**, 20 Union Square East (Henry Bacon, 1905–07), designated 1996. The bold academic classicism of this white granite bank building with its Corinthian temple front reveals the design aesthetic of Henry Bacon, an architect best known for the monumental Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The Institution for the Savings of Merchants' Clerks, established in 1848, was renamed the Union Square Savings Bank in 1904. The bank remained an independent institution until 1968, when it merged with another bank. The building is now used as a theater.

❖ **Century Association Building**, 111 East 15th Street (Gambrell & Richardson, 1869), designated 1993. Not only is this the oldest surviving clubhouse building in Manhattan, but it appears to be an early work of Henry Hobson Richardson, who would later become one of America's most influential architects. Charles Gambrell began planning the clubhouse in 1866, before Richardson was a member of the club or Gambrell's partner, but by the time the building was erected, the firm Gambrell & Richardson had been formed and Richardson had become a Centurion. Although it is not clear what the relative contribution of each partner was to

the design, the massing and the employment of a mansard roof and stylized neo-Grec detail resemble features on other early buildings by Richardson and may reflect his French training. The Century Association moved to 43rd Street (see No. 303) in 1891. In 1996–97 the building was rehabilitated, and it is now occupied by the Trinity Broadcasting Network.

❖ **Germania Life Insurance Company Building**, now the W Hotel, 201 Park Avenue South (50 Union Square East) (D'Oench & Yost, 1910–11), designated 1988. Prominently located on a corner site overlooking Union Square, the headquarters of the Germania Life Insurance Company (renamed Guardian Life in 1918 in response to anti-German sentiment during World War I) is a 20-story tower with a tripartite massing. The building is crowned by an enormous mansard roof atop which stands an early example of electric signage.

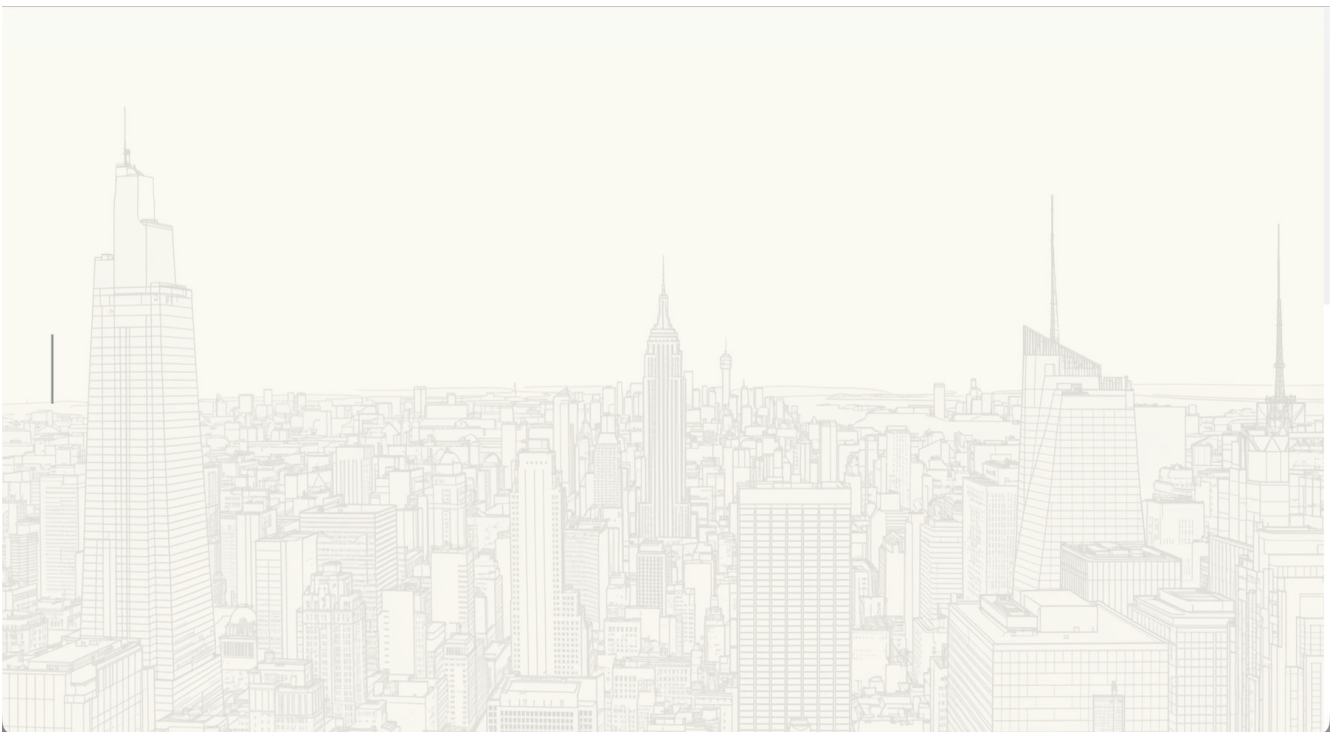
❖ **Scheffel Hall**, 150 Third Avenue (Weber & Drosser, 1894–95), designated 1997. This small ornate building recalls the period when Manhattan's Lower East Side was known as Kleindeutschland or Little Germany. Designed by Henry Adam Weber and Hubert Drosser, the white terracotta facade was closely modeled on the Friedrichsbau, an early 17th-century building at Heidelberg Castle. Built as a beer hall and restaurant, it was named for the German poet Joseph Victor von Scheffel, author of *Gaudeamus*, a collection of student songs. After 1928 it was used by the German-American Athletic Club, and beginning in the 1970s, Fat Tuesday's, a popular jazz club.

❖ **Friends Meeting House and Seminary**, 15 Rutherford Place and 226 East 16th Street (attributed to Charles T. Bunting, 1861), designated 1969. This austere brick meetinghouse and the adjoining seminary, with its finely proportioned massing and original multipaned windows, were erected by a group of Quakers known as the Hicksites, who were more traditional in their mode of worship than the Orthodox Quakers (see No. 235). Having been divided since the mid-19th century, the two groups reconciled in 1958, retaining this building as their meetinghouse.

❖ **Saint George's Church (Episcopal)**, Rutherford Place at East 16th Street (Blesch & Eidlitz, 1846–56), designated 1967. This massive round-arched stone building dominating Stuyvesant Square is one of the first and most significant examples of Early Romanesque Revival church architecture in America. The exterior, probably the work of the Bavarian-born architect Otto Blesch, reflects the influence that the Ger-

Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016, p. 515

Quotes drawn from this page: 24



education. The five-story, H-plan building has two side courts that provide light and ventilation. Designed in a Beaux-Arts style with distinctive classical and secessionist detail, the main façade on East 15th Street is clad in tan brick and limestone with stone ornament, and is dominated by a pedimented entrance pavilion flanked on each side by three bays of windows. The East 16th Street façade is red brick above a limestone base, with "Stuyvesant High School" inscribed above the entrance.

Stuyvesant quickly became one of the most prestigious high schools in the city, noted for mathematics, technology, and especially the sciences. Since 1934, admission has been based on a competitive entrance examination. In 1967, a Brooklyn girl sued the Board of Education to gain admission to Stuyvesant, and the subsequent court decision opened the school to girls in 1969.

In 1992, Stuyvesant High School relocated to a new facility in Battery Park City. The original building remains in use by the High School for Health Professions and Human Services, the Institute for Collaborative Education, and P.S. 226M, a special-education program.

DARYL ROTH THEATRE, FORMERLY AMERICAN SAVINGS BANK, ORIGINALLY UNION SQUARE SAVINGS BANK

1905–07; 1937; 1961; 1998

20 UNION SQUARE EAST (ALSO KNOWN AS 101–103 EAST 15TH STREET), MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: HENRY BACON; VOORHEES, GMLIN AND WALKER; VOORHEES, WALKER, SMITH, SMITH AND HAINES

DESIGNATED: FEBRUARY 13, 1996



DARYL ROTH THEATRE

This bank, originally the Institution for Savings of Merchants' Clerks, was founded in 1848 to "encourage the clerks of business men to take care of their earnings." Half a century later, the bank realized that its name was no longer suitable to an institution that had depositors of all professions, and so it changed its name to the Union Square Savings Bank.

The bank building is one of the largest and best-known banks designed by Henry Bacon, who also designed the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The Union Square Bank is a flat-roofed building covered in Troy white granite. The main façade design is a free-standing portico on four fluted Corinthian columns supporting the entablature and parapet. Above the columns is a cornice with dentils, egg and dart moldings, and carved faces of lions.

In 1937, the firm Voorhees, Gmelin and Walker constructed a set-back penthouse addition. Voorhees, Walker,

Smith, Smith and Haines redesigned the entrance in 1961. The bank closed in 1992, and the building was acquired by Daryl Roth in 1996. In 1998, the building underwent exterior restoration and interior redesign. It now houses the Daryl Roth Theatre with the DR2 Theatre in the adjacent garage. A contemporary sign that features the current production now covers a portion of the frieze, which once bore the original bank name.

WEST STREET BUILDING

1905–07; 2003–05

90 WEST STREET AND 140 CEDAR STREET, MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: CASS GILBERT; FAÇADE MAINTENANCE, DESIGN P.C.

ARCHITECTS & ENGINEERING;

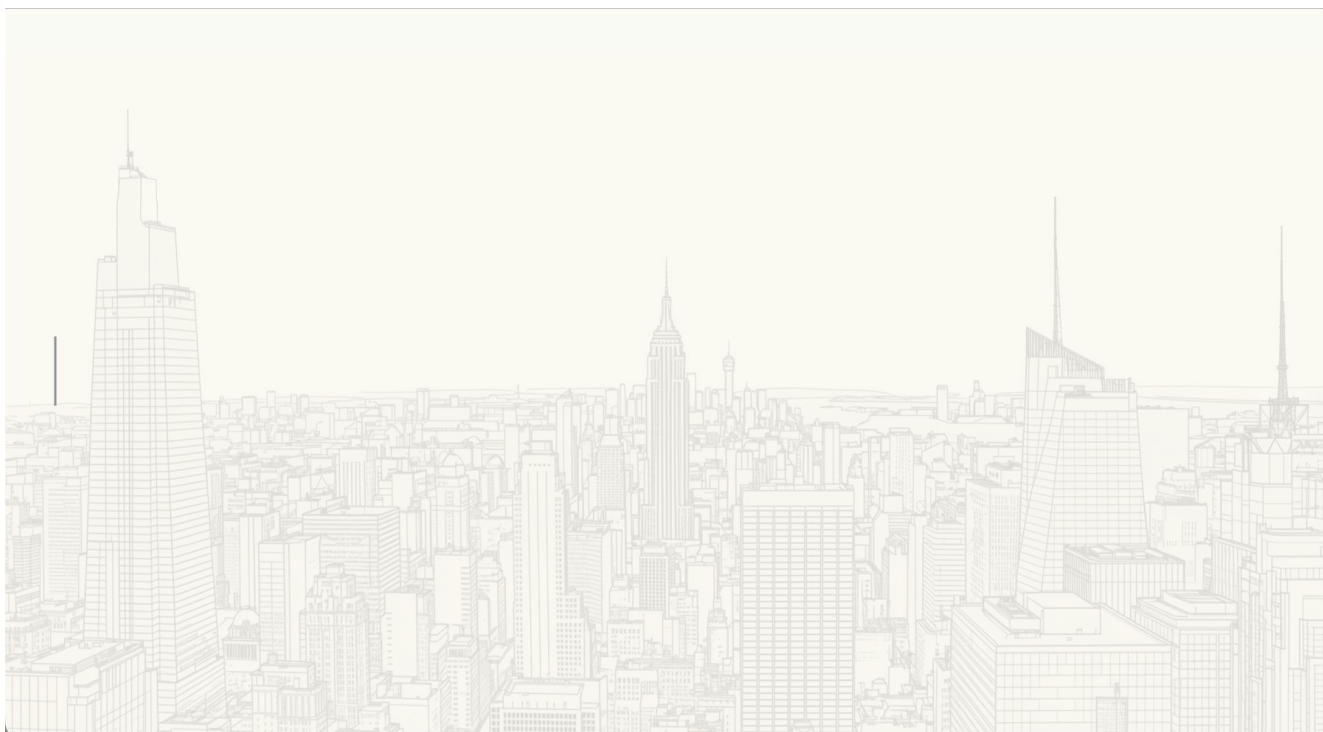
RESIDENTIAL CONVERSION, H. THOMAS O'HARA

DESIGNATED: MAY 19, 1998

Designed by Cass Gilbert, one of New York City's most renowned skyscraper architects, this building was significantly damaged in the terrorist attacks of September 11, 2001. Formally, this building is considered a transition between the early "base-shaft-capital" skyscraper designs of the late nineteenth century and the romantic towers of the 1920s, exemplified by Gilbert's Woolworth Building. Gilbert's pioneering design includes Gothic influences, which are also considered unusual for this time period, but foreshadow his later masterpiece for F.W. Woolworth. Clustered piers in the middle section anticipate exploration of

Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 250

Quotes drawn from this page: 25



familiar sight in the city. With the departure of the insurance company, the building was converted into a hotel (Rockwell Group, 2001). Alas, the old sign is gone (despite a public outcry), replaced by the hotel's own. Interestingly, the former name of Guardian was the Germania Life Insurance Company, but anti-German sentiment during World War I resulted in a reshuffling of the letters of Germania to Guardian. The aluminum and glass annex to the east was designed in 1961 by Skidmore, Owings & Merrill.

Around the corner, the trim neo-Federal-style brick-and-limestone building, No. 100 East 17th Street (Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, 1929), was the "final resting place" of **Tammany Hall**, the Democratic political machine that held the city in a corrupt stranglehold for almost two centuries. The club was founded in 1788 as an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty and called The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order. According to local preservationist Jack Taylor, "the building is such a great example of Colonial Revival, of a time when a group tried to burnish its crooked reputation by linking itself to early American ideals," adding, "the history of Tammany Hall, shabby as it is, is also a big part of our past, and this building is the sole physical remnant of that." While awaiting the city's decision on landmark designation, it was suggested that the Tammany Hall building be converted into a "Museum of Political Corruption"; however, one wag observed that "it just wouldn't be large enough!"

By 1943, unable to meet its mortgage payments, Tammany sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union. In 2001, they, in turn, sold it to Liberty Theaters, who remodeled the union's former meeting hall—once called the Roosevelt Auditorium—into the present **Union Square Theater**. The building is also home to the **New York Film Academy**, a noted school for filmmakers.

At East 15th Street, look above the ground floor of No. 24–33 at the dingy cast-iron façade of the **former S. Klein-on-the-Square Department Store**. Klein's first opened on the Square in 1910, but by 1921 relocated to a rambling emporium that grew northward from 14th to 16th streets. For years, its huge distinctive neon "On the Square" sign atop the complex was a familiar city landmark. Klein's was a pioneer in discount merchandising, and its frequent sales would always attract hordes of bargain hunters. By 1975, however, competition from other discount stores and its distance from the city's new shopping centers, plus old-fashioned merchandising techniques and a rather decrepit interior, hastened its demise. The southwest corner of Klein's 15th Street building was earlier the site of the posh **Union Square Hotel**, a favorite with the Theater District celebrities of the Gilded Age.

At the northeast corner is the **former Union Square Savings Bank**, now the **Daryl Roth Theatre**, No. 20 Union Square East (Henry Bacon, 1905). Like a vestige of ancient Greece, the white granite-front structure boasts a façade of bold Corinthian columns, in a style favored by architect Bacon, whose major work is the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The bank closed in 1992, but the ven-

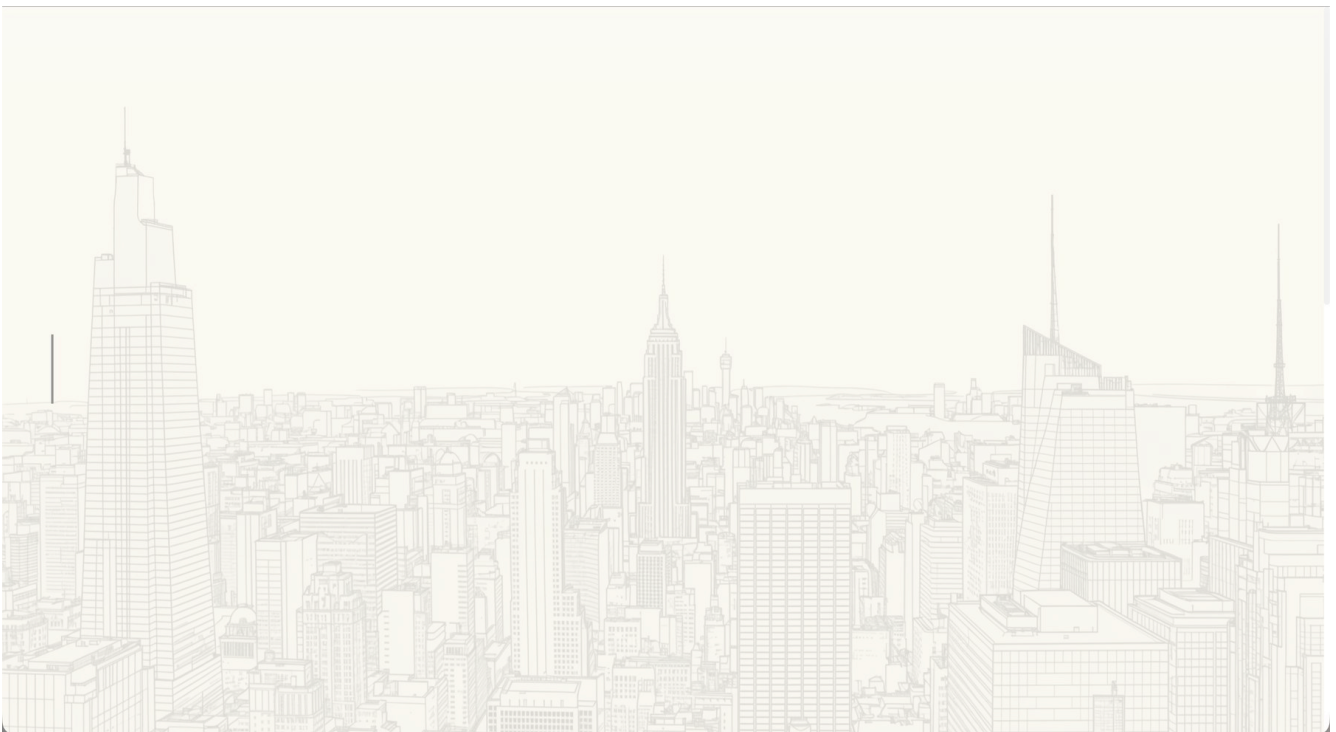
the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The bank closed in 1972, but the venerable building is now enjoying a new life, with the former banking hall remodeled and converted for novel and unconventional theatrical productions.

Walk into the park to the bronze Statue of Lafayette, by famed French sculptor Frédéric Auguste Bartholdi (1876). While collecting funds for his later Statue

845.1

JG, *Union Square*, 1916, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 26

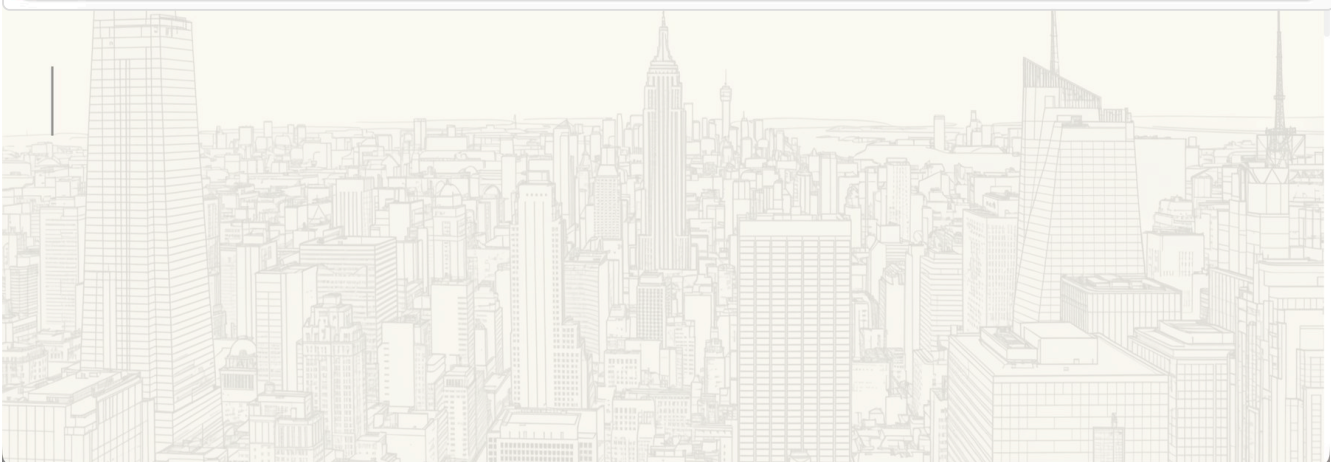


“<Architecture Style>_Renaissance-Revival, <Base Color>_Cornflower - 149 205 233, <Façade Color>_Timberwolf - 217 214 208, <Base Material>_Painted Stone, **Granite** Bulkheads, <Façade Material>_Brick, Stone, Concrete, <Entrance Description>_Storefront, Awning, <Window Detail>_Pilasters, Molding Details, Recessed, Window Panes: [2/2], Arched (Right & Left Wings), <Brickwork Style>_Running Bond, Belt Course/Sill Course, Egg & Dart Course, Bezzant, <Roofline Description>_Flat, Parapet.”

JG · (1916) UNION SQUARE · 1916 · P. 1

Mentioned as: "24 Union Square East"

[View Document Image](#)



Dolkart, *Gramercy*, 1996, p. 78

Quotes drawn from this page: 28





NOS. 100-102 EAST 17TH STREET
Former Tammany Hall

On the southeast corner of East 17th Street and Union Square East, at 100-102 East 17th Street, stands the second of the district's institutional buildings, **Tammany Hall**, once the headquarters of New York City's Democratic Party political machine. Late in 1927, the Society of Tammany sold its headquarters on East 14th Street and announced the construction of a new Tammany Hall. Plans for the new building were made public in January 1928.⁵⁰ The building, designed by Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted). The *Real Estate Record* described the design as "a dignified architectural treatment, one of the chief motifs of which are the severe Colonial columns in the centers of the Union Square and the Seventeenth-street facades which recall the days of early American architecture."⁵¹

The Colonial Revival was undoubtedly chosen not only because it was reminiscent of the architecture of the early republic, but also because it symbolized the government established during that period. The Society of Tammany was attempting to associate itself with the ideals of early American democracy; in fact, the Union Square facade bears a striking resemblance to the original Federal Hall, where George Washington took the oath of office as the first President of the United States. By choosing the Colonial Revival style, with all that it symbolized, Tammany may have been attempting to create the image of a truly democratic force to counter the accusations that it was a corrupt political machine.

50. "Architects Picked for Tammany Hall," *New York Times*, January 18, 1928, p. 52; "New Tammany Hall Will Be Colonial in Design," *Real Estate Record and Builders Guide* 121 (January 28, 1928), p. 7. The *Real Estate Record* article includes an elevation drawing. A slightly different elevation drawing, closer to the building as actually constructed, was illustrated in the Architectural League's *Yearbook* (1929), n.p.

51. "New Tammany Hall..."

“<Architecture Style>_Postmodern, <Base Color>_Crystal
- 213 213 213, <Façade Color>_Copper - 217 138 105, <Base
Material>_Brick, Granite, <Façade Material>_Brick,
<Entrance Description>_Storefront, Double Height,
Recessed, Granite Surround, <Window
Detail>_Tripartite or 5 Part, <Brickwork
Style>_Running Bond, <Roofline Description>_4 Finial
Towers, Pyramidal.”

AIA · (1987) UNION SQUARE · 1987 · P. 1

Mentioned as: “1 Irving Place”

[View Document Image](#)



Dolkart, *Gramercy*, 1996, p. 88

Quotes drawn from this page: 31



EAST 15TH STREET



NO. 105 EAST 15TH STREET

and to the right at No. 109, the former Century Association Clubhouse, a designated landmark

SWANNANOA

105 East 15th Street

Architect: Gilbert A. Schellinger

Date: 1898-1900

THE SWANNANOA is a 10-story Neo-Renaissance apartment building designed by a prolific designer of residential buildings whose name is generally associated with single-family rowhouses. The building was planned with 40 apartments, four on each floor. Its most imposing feature is the two-story base with granite pilasters and projecting portico supported by four granite columns. Above the portico are

seven-story rounded bays, undoubtedly designed to provide residents with views toward nearby Union Square. The brick-faced upper floors are extensively ornamented with terra cotta, including foliate detail, cartouches, lion heads, and dolphins.



NOS. 135 AND 137 EAST 15TH STREET

Architect unknown

Date: c. 1843 and early 1850s

THESE TWO four-story and basement rowhouses were erected in the initial stage of residential development in the Gramercy Park neighborhood. No. 135 is an imposing Greek Revival dwelling with a fine stone entrance enframing and exceptionally well-preserved wrought- and cast-iron railings; its cornice dates from later in the 19th century. No. 137 is a slightly later Italianate house that also retains a handsome stone entrance enframing and original ironwork.

Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 97

Quotes drawn from this page: 32





D-6 Marquis de Lafayette, 1873

Sculptor: *Frédéric-Auguste Bartholdi (1834–1904). Pedestal by: H. W. DeStuckle. Media and size: Bronze statue, over life-size; granite pedestal.*

Location: *Union Square, 845.1 side between 15th and 16th Streets.*

Bartholdi's emotionally charged portrait of the Marquis de Lafayette (1757–1834) suggests an actor in a historical melodrama. In a letter of February 17, 1872, the sculptor explained his intentions to the French director of fine arts: "I would like to propose to you that I describe as completely and simply as possible the act of arrival and the ardor and devotion of the hero." The artist shows Lafayette standing on a ship's prow in the act of pledging his heart and sword to the American revolutionaries.

When the youthful, idealistic, and wealthy Lafayette arrived in this country he enlisted for the cause of liberty and soon won a congressional

commission as a major-general in the Continental Army. Lafayette spent much of his own fortune aiding the Revolution. His success in America also helped persuade France to send troops and supplies, most notably Rochambeau's expeditionary force which helped Washington win the decisive Battle of Yorktown.

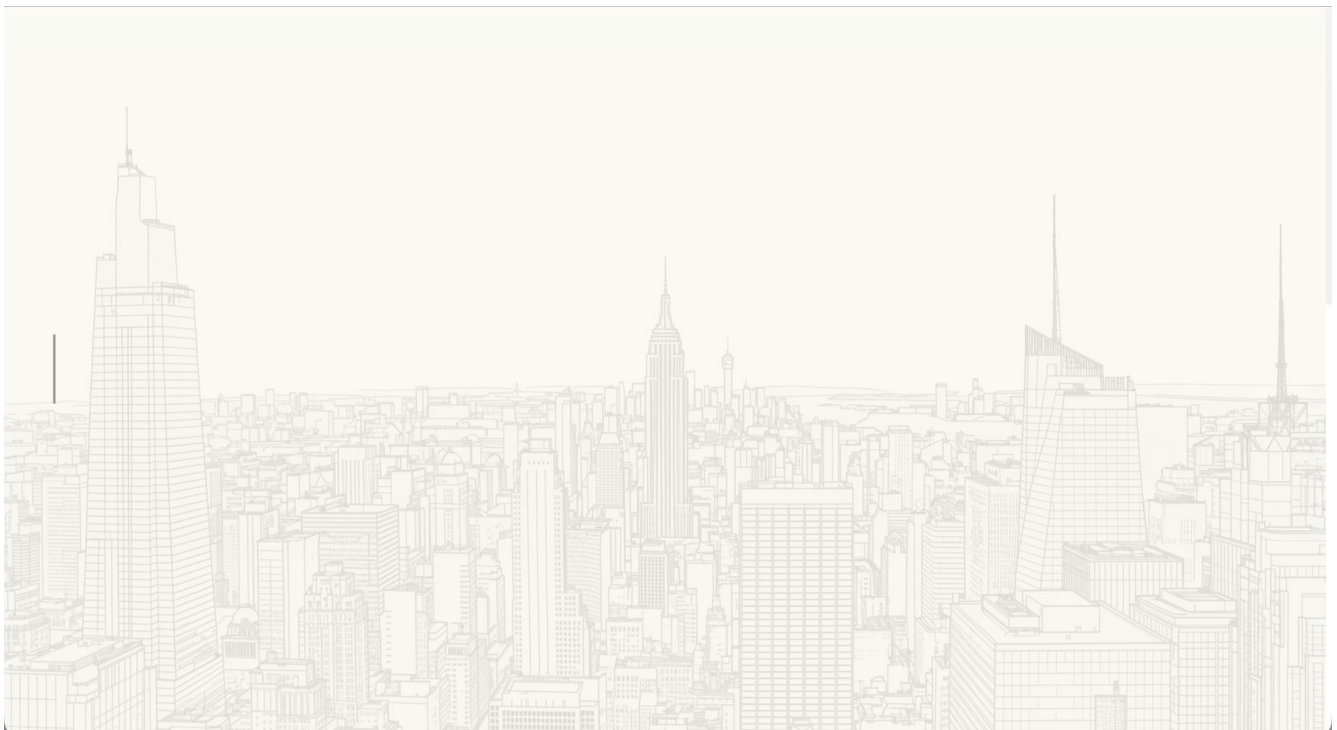
Lafayette became a legend in his own time. Invited to revisit the United States in 1824 by President Monroe, he was acclaimed as he toured the country for a year, beginning with his historic visit to New York City. Samuel F. B. Morse's famous painting of the older Lafayette, now in City Hall, marks that occasion.

Dedicated: September 6, 1876. Signed and dated: A. Bartholdi 1873 and H. W. DeStuckle, Arch. Foundry mark: F. Barbedienne Fondateur-Paris. Collection of: City of New York; gift of the French government in recognition of the aid provided by New Yorkers to Parisians during the Franco-Prussian War; French residents of New York paid for the pedestal.

MIDTOWN SOUTH 97

Nelson & Sons, *Nelsons Guide to the City of New York*, 1858, p. 39

Quotes drawn from this page: 33



We now enter

845

UNION SQUARE,

which presents many objects worthy of notice. The Park is an oval enclosure, beautifully laid out and ornamented by a fountain. On the south-east corner of the Square, at the junction of Broadway with Fourth Avenue is the famous

EQUESTRIAN STATUE OF WASHINGTON,

a work of art which is universally admired. The statue itself is of bronze, and is raised upon a granite pedestal of plain device. The height of the statue is fourteen and a half feet, and, including the pedestal, reaches to an elevation of twenty-nine feet. It engaged the artist, Mr. Brown, during four years, and its cost was upwards of 30,000 dollars. It is justly regarded as a triumph of art, expressing with great truthfulness and power the high qualities of the patriot whom it commemorates ; while the attitude of the horse and its exquisite proportions serve only to heighten the effect of the composition, without obtrusively withdrawing the eye from the principal figure.

On the west or left hand side of the Square are also to be noticed, Rev. M. Abbot's Spinglar Institute for Ladies, and the "Church of the Puritans," of Dr. Cheever.

On the upper side of the Square, and on Seventeenth Street, as seen in the Engraving, is

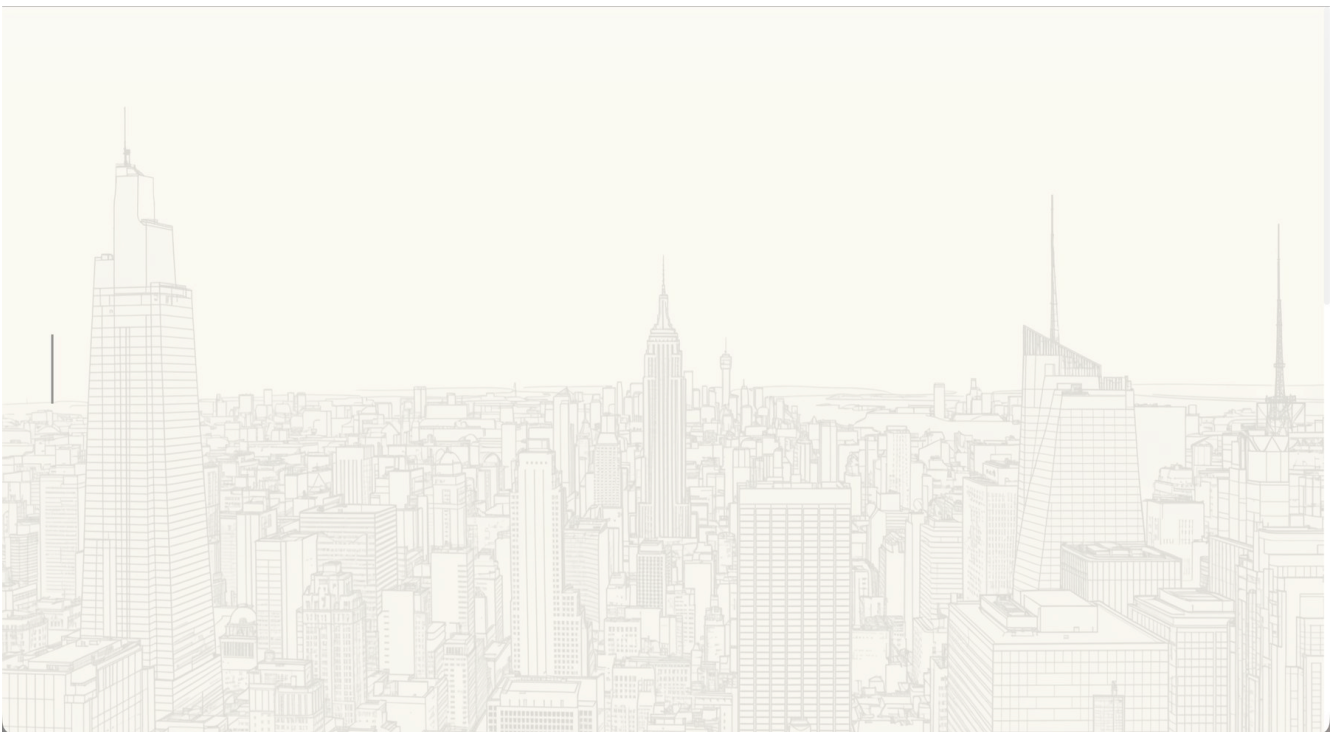
846.2

THE EVERETT HOUSE,

**a magnificent hotel, of recent erection. It combines
the luxuries of a first-class hotel with the quiet and**

Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 91

Quotes drawn from this page: 34





D-1 Photo, ca. 1935

D-1 George Washington, 1853–1855

Sculptor: Henry Kirke Brown (1814–1886). Pedestal by: Richard Upjohn. Media and size: Bronze equestrian statue, 14 feet high; granite

pedestal. Location: *Union Square, in the center of the terrace facing 14th Street.*

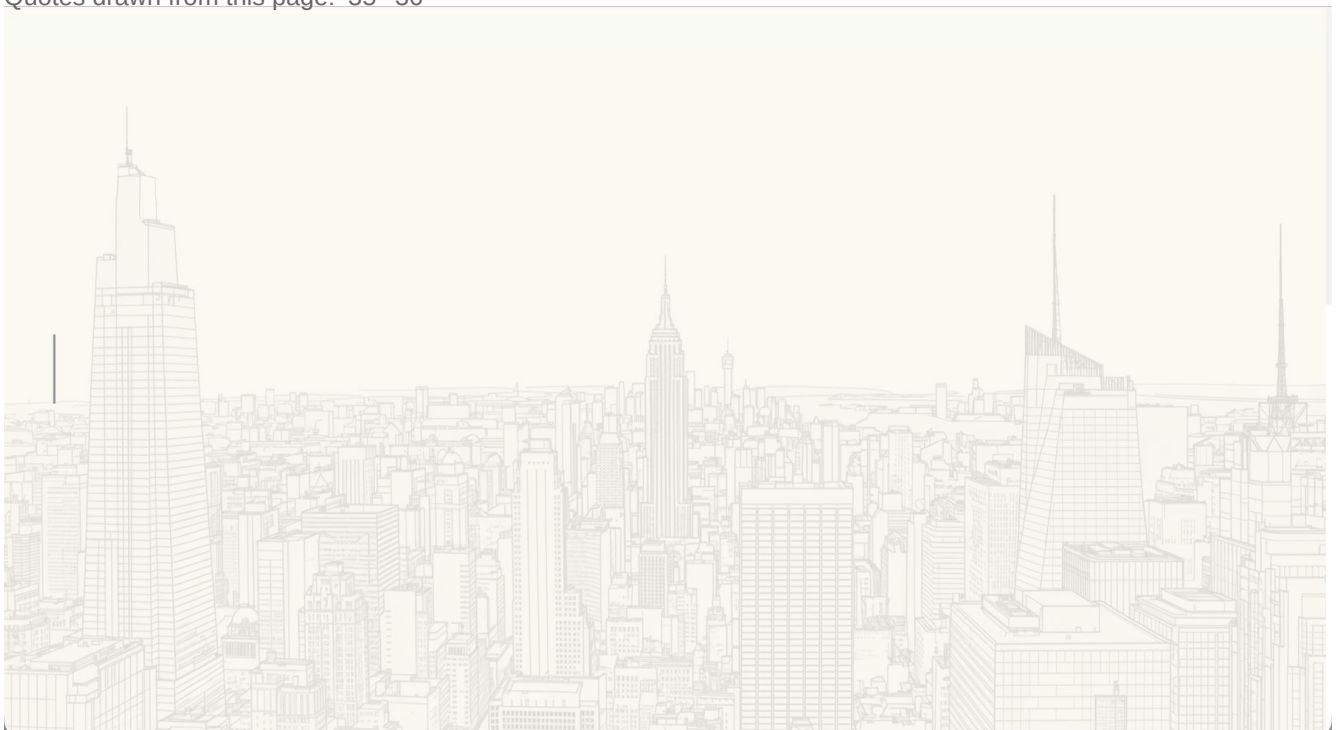
845.1

New Yorkers wanted an equestrian statue of George Washington as early as 1802, but it was not until 1851 that a viable Washington monument committee was organized. It sought out Henry Greenough, prominent neoclassical sculptor, and Henry Kirke Brown to do the job, perhaps jointly, although just how that would work out was not clear. However, Greenough died almost at once and Brown, with the assistance of J. Q. A. Ward, created the Union Square *Washington*, the city's first major outdoor bronze statue. It was unveiled on July 4, 1856. A dignified and vigorous work, it exemplified Brown's passionate belief that American artists should celebrate their American heritage, using what art historian Wayne Craven calls a "simple and direct naturalism." They should, he felt, even use American foundries, although few such existed, rather than ship pieces abroad for casting. Brown's *Washington* was only the second equestrian to be cast in the United

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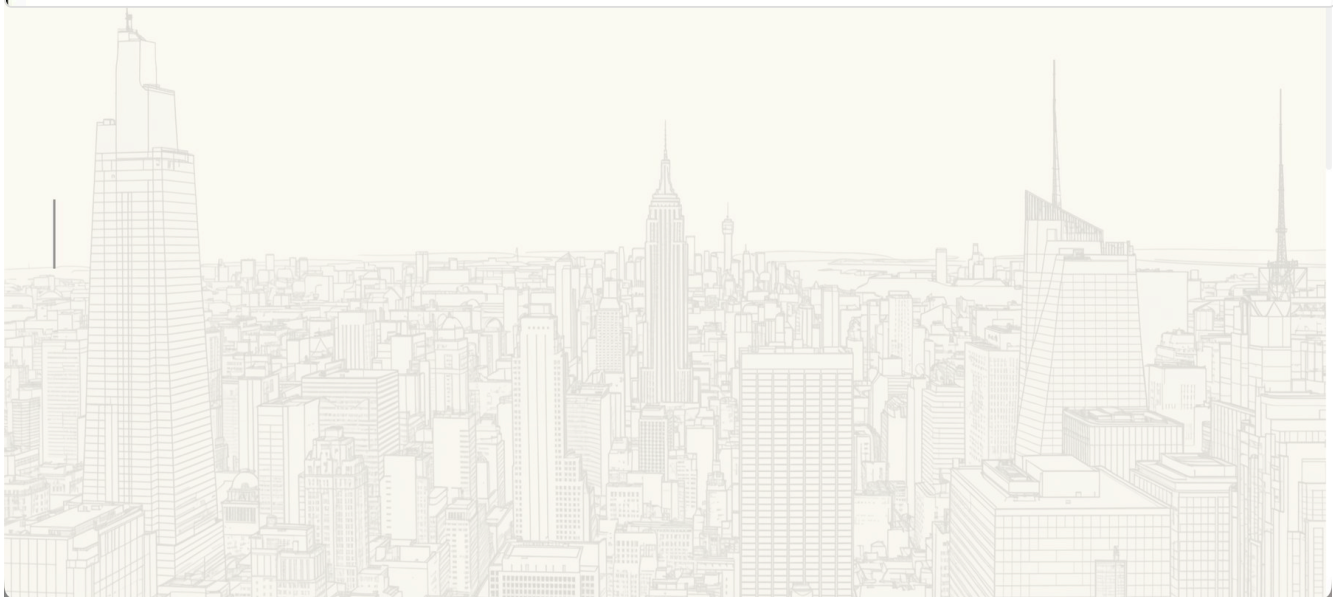
Sharp, *New York City Public Sculpture*, 1974, p. 28

Quotes drawn from this page: 35 36





7.
EQUESTRIAN STATUE OF GEORGE WASHINGTON
 Henry Kirke Brown (1814 – 1886)
 845.1 *Union Square Park*
 Unveiled July 4, 1856
 Bronze statue, granite base



Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 93

Quotes drawn from this page: 37





D-2 Mohandas Gandhi, 1986

845.1

Sculptor: Kantilal B. Patel (1925–). Media and size: Bronze statue, over life-size; granite pedestal. Location: Union Square, on the southwest pedestrian triangle, 14th Street at Broadway.

Advocate of nonviolent protest, Mohandas Gandhi (1869–1948), better

known as Mahatma Gandhi (Great Soul), is depicted here holding his familiar walking stick and wearing the dhoti, a reference to Hindu asceticism. The simple home-spun cotton garment also reminds us of Gandhi's efforts to revive Indian home industries, particularly the spinning of yarn. Gandhi was one of this century's extraordinary political and religious leaders. An Indian nationalist, he dedicated his life to India's struggle for independence from the British. Saintly in his simplicity and religious devotion, Gandhi advocated passive noncooperation, initiating boycotts and personal fasts.

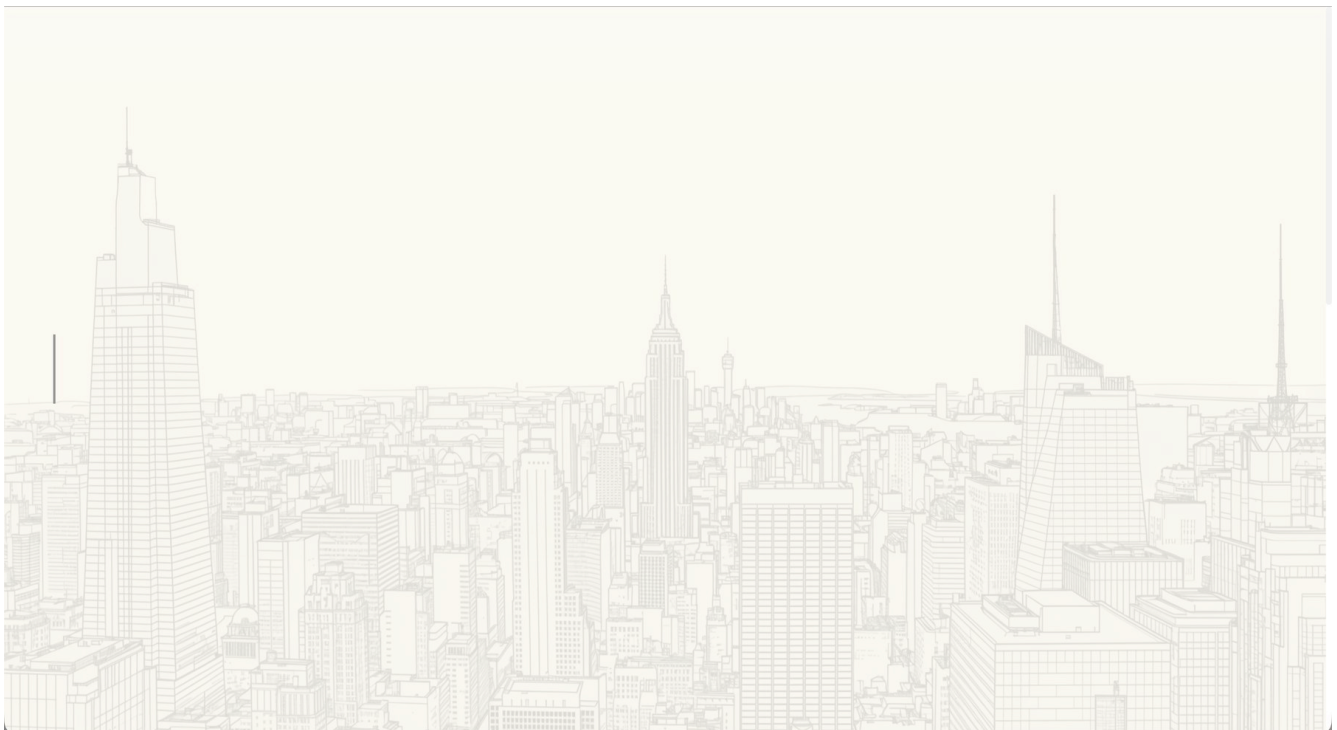
According to Parks Department Commissioner Henry J. Stern, the Parks Department chose this park for the statue's location because of the tradition of protest associated with Union Square. Gandhi's likeness joins those of American patriots, Lincoln, Washington, and Lafayette.

Dedicated: *October 2, 1986. Collection of: City of New York; gift of the Gandhi Memorial International Foundation.*

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Cook, *Sacred Havens*, 2001, p. 42

Quotes drawn from this page: 38



SACRED HAVENS

After India won its liberation from British rule in 1947, the country was divided into Hindu India and Moslem Pakistan. Gandhi unsuccessfully fought the partition. In 1948 he was assassinated by a Hindu extremist who blamed Gandhi for the division.

In his early years, Gandhi was not always the humble man who led India out of subjugation. His autobiography tells stories of his days as an accomplished attorney who personally felt the sting of prejudice and fought for his oppressed countrymen in South Africa's judicial system.

ARCHITECTURE

The Gandhi Garden is a triangular-shaped plot of land on the southern side of Union Square Park. A black wrought iron railing surrounds the well-tended garden and holds the monument. The life-sized bronze statue rests on a granite base which together measures 14 feet in height. Kantilal B. Patel, the sculptor, shows Gandhi wrapped in a dhoti, a garment of homespun cotton. Carrying a walking stick, wearing sandals and wire-rimmed eyeglasses, Gandhi is captured in full stride to show his determination for India's independence.

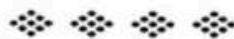
The pure simplicity of the statue brilliantly recalls this extraordinary leader who believed that "in a gentle way, you can shake the world." Perhaps as you meditate on Gandhi's words, you'll smile back at the Mahatma's kindly gaze.

845.1

ADDRESS: 14th Street at Broadway and Union Square

PHONE: Maintained by NYC Parks Department

HOURS: Public Space

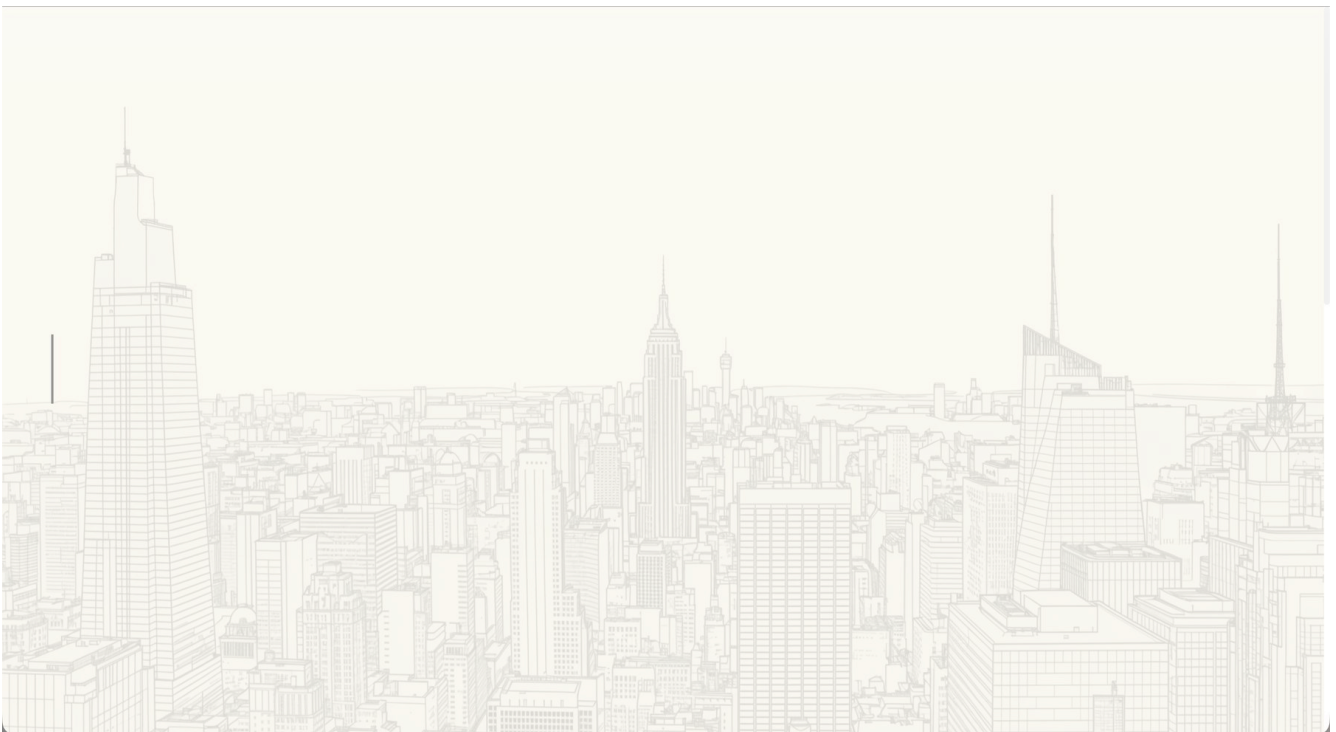


BY THE WAY

As you make your rounds in LOWER MANHATTAN, you may wish to visit other spiritual places. Some are public, others are open at special times. Be sure to call ahead.

Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 94

Quotes drawn from this page: 39 40





D-3 Photo, ca. 1905

D-3 Union Square Drinking Fountain, 1881

Sculptor: Karl Adolph Donndorf (1835–1916). Media and size: Bronze group, over life-size; pink granite pedestal. Location: Union Square, west side between 15th and 16th Streets.

845.1

Today outdoor drinking fountains are rare in New York City, but in the 19th century they were common civic amenities. They served a need and promoted ideals of health, charity, and temperance. Daniel Willis James (1832–1907), a leading philanthropist, donated this fountain for Union Square, hoping, he said, "it shall be the means of kindling in any heart that spirit of love—Charity—it is intended to illustrate."

Inspired by fountains they viewed while touring Germany, Daniel Willis James and Theodore Roosevelt formulated a plan for a comparable fountain for New York City. They hired J. Leonard Corning to select an artist and oversee the details of the commission. Corning recommended the German academic sculptor Karl Adolf Donndorf, who signed a contract on May 10, 1877, stipulating that the work be completed in 2½ years.

Donndorf's elaborate and very Victorian work incorporates a number of

Donndorf's elaborate and very Victorian work integrates a complex bronze figurative group with a richly ornamented pedestal that originally held the plumbing and drinking spouts for water. The central figure, a mother holding a baby, is the traditional allegorical symbol for charity. Standing calmly and enfolded in graceful classicizing drapery, she gazes lovingly down at a small son who reaches for a pitcher at her side. The artist used his wife and baby as models for the group.

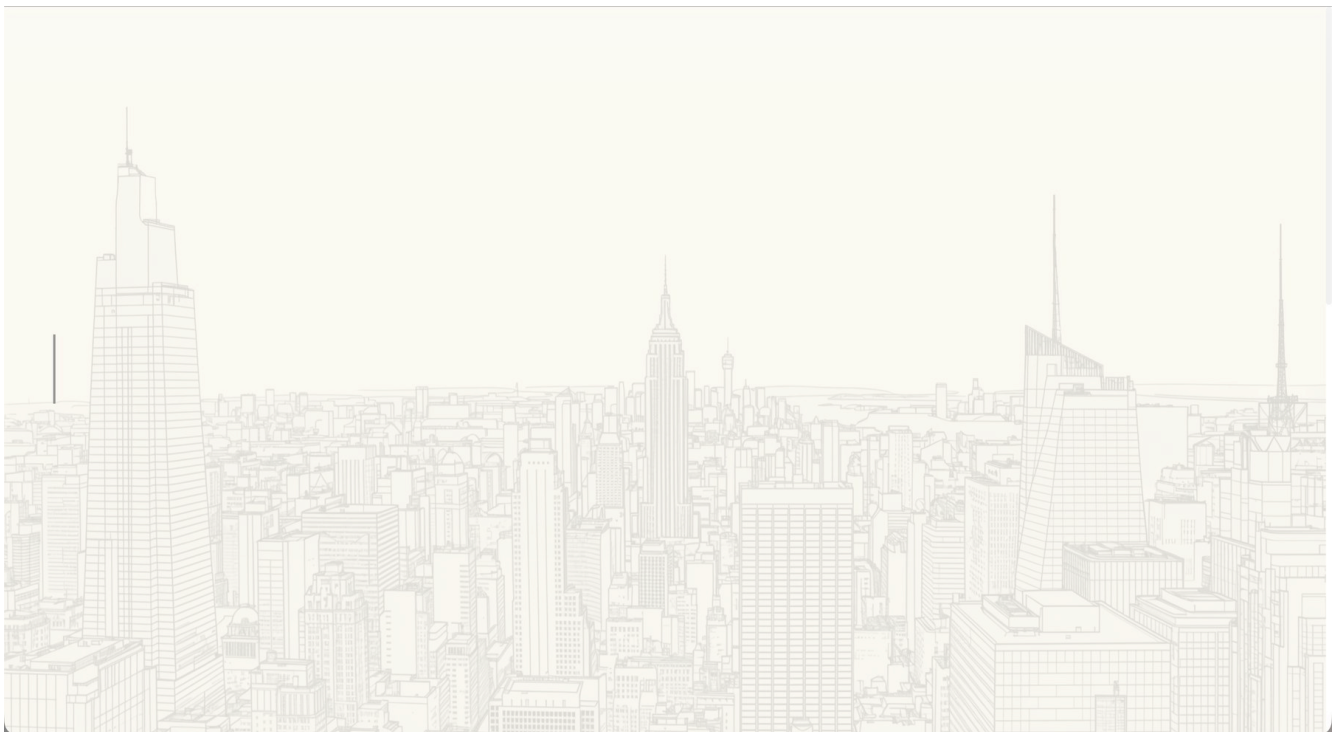
The concept of benign nature underlies the decorative motifs of birds, fruit, flowers, and four lizards embellishing the octagonal pink granite pedestal. Previously, water issued from four lions' heads, a motif found in Greek and Roman fountains, into four basins below, and tin drinking cups hung from chains next to the water spouts.

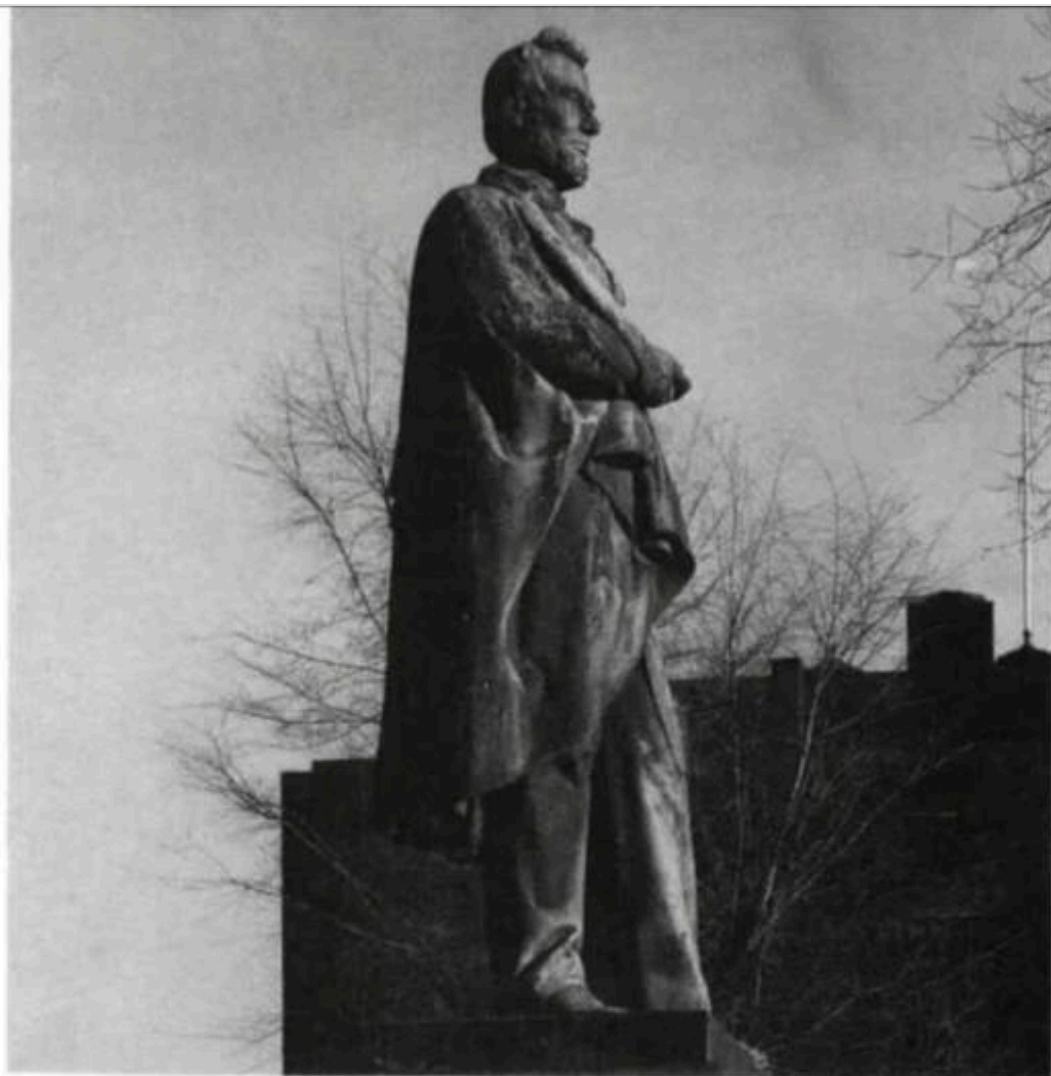
Dedicated: *October 25, 1881. Signed: A. Donndorf. fec. Foundry mark: G. Howaldt—Braunschweig / 1881. Collection of: City of New York; gift of Daniel Willis James.*

94 MANHATTAN'S OUTDOOR SCULPTURE

Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 96

Quotes drawn from this page: 41





D-5 Photo, ca. 1920

D-5 Abraham Lincoln, 1868

Sculptor: *Henry Kirke Brown (1814–1886).* **Media and size:** *Bronze statue, over life-size; granite pedestal.* **Location:** *Union Square, north end on the axis with 16th Street.*

845.1

Soon after the assassination of Abraham Lincoln in 1865, the Union League Club, a Republican organization founded two years earlier to promote good government, commissioned Henry Kirke Brown to create this commemorative statue. Of the many outdoor portrait statues of Lincoln erected in the United States, this appears to be the first in New York City. Sculptor Brown made a somewhat similar image of Lincoln for the then-City of Brooklyn. It was placed in Prospect Park.

The 16th president's tall rangy frame, gaunt features, and characteristic brooding expression are familiar to all Americans. Brown shows the

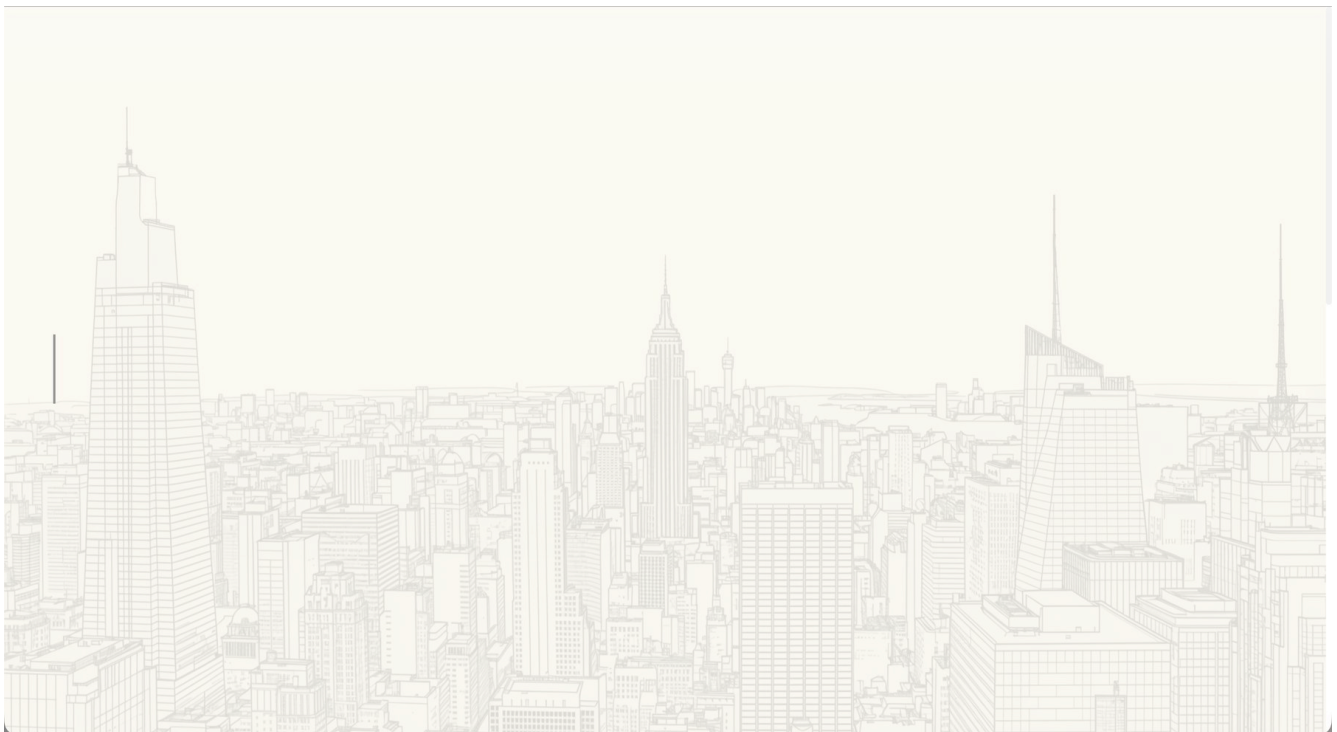
statesman in a pensive mood, standing with one foot advanced. In his left hand is a scroll, possibly his second inaugural address. An excerpt from that speech, "with malice toward none; with charity toward all," was inscribed on a fence that originally surrounded the statue. A vestige of neoclassicism, a cloak envelops Lincoln's contemporary, baggy attire. Sculptors of the day often combined neoclassical elements with a more direct naturalism, tempering realism with idealism. Brown's portrait of Lincoln is a convincing likeness, but as is often true of this artist's work, it lacks psychological depth.

Dedicated: *September 16, 1870. Signed: H.K. Brown. Foundry mark: R. Wood & Co. / Bronze Founders / Phila.* **Collection of:** *City of New York; gift by public subscription under the auspices of the Union League Club.*

96 MANHATTAN'S OUTDOOR SCULPTURE

Gayle & Cohen, *Manhattans Outdoor Sculptures*, 1988, p. 95

Quotes drawn from this page: 43





D-4 Model for relief, ca. 1926

D-4 Charles F. Murphy Memorial Flagpole, 1926

Sculptor: *Anthony de Francisci (1887–1964).* **Pedestal by:** *Perry Coke Smith.* **Media and size:** *Granite flagpole base, 36 feet in diameter; bronze bas-reliefs, 9½ feet high.* **Location:** *Center of Union Square.* 845.1

This elaborate flagpole is variously known as the Independence Flagstaff and the Murphy Memorial, a dual identity arising from its history. It marks the site of an earlier flagpole, erected by the Tammany Society under the direction of Tammany Hall boss Charles F. Murphy (1858–1924). When Murphy died, his supporters wanted to transform the flagpole into a monument to him, but Murphy was a controversial figure and numerous New Yorkers opposed the plan; they did not want a monument to Murphy to dominate Union Square and overshadow the statues of national heroes Lincoln, Washington, and Lafayette. Instead, donors raised the new flagpole in honor of the 150th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence. The resulting Independence Flagstaff recalls the liberty poles of pre-Revolutionary times which English colonists erected to protest English

policies.

On the southern face of the extensive drum-like base of the flagpole is a large plaque displaying the Declaration of Independence. Two bronze reliefs encircle the base. To the right is an allegory representing the evolution of civilization under democratic rule, which sculptor de Francisci contrasts with the relief on the left, representing civilization under tyrannical rule. Above the bronze reliefs is a freedom plaque bearing the coats of arms of the 13 original colonies. In 1987 Parks Department officials restored the monument and reinstalled the towering flagpole, one of the tallest in the state.

Dedicated: *July 4, 1930. Signed and dated: Anthony de Francisci / Perry Coke Smith / 1926. Foundry mark: Roman Bronze Works, New York. Collection of: City of New York; gift of the Charles F. Murphy Committee.*

